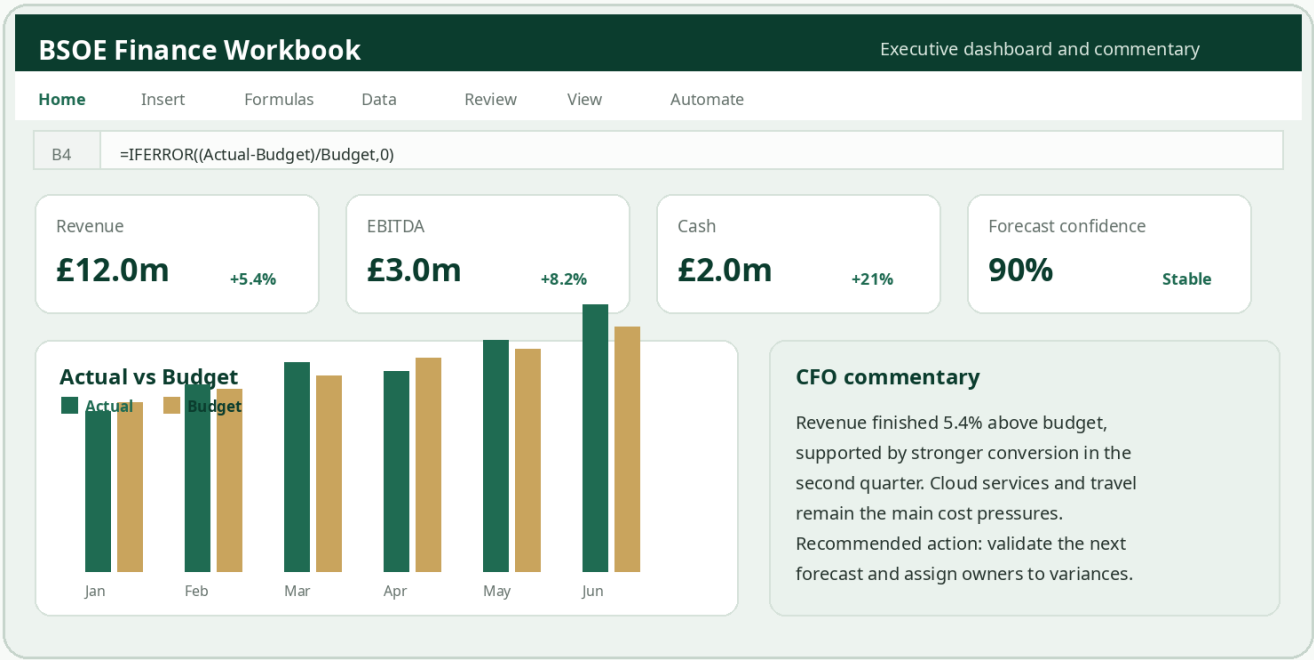


100 TIPS FOR AI IN FINANCE

A practical handbook for finance professionals



BSOE Institute - Adapted Educational Edition

Redesigned in the BSOE dark green, forest green, gold and near-white palette. Reproduced and adapted with permission.

About This Edition

Purpose

This edition is designed as a neutral, institution-ready training handbook. Personal biography references, promotional calls to action and individual contact details have been removed.

The learning content remains focused on practical AI use in finance: foundations, data and numbers, prompting, custom AI, governance and CFO-led transformation.

Excel-style visuals have been redrawn to demonstrate auditable formulas, data readiness, financial modelling, dashboards, cleaning workflows, governance and adoption roadmaps.

BSOE Finance Workbook						Auditable formulas and spot checks	
Home	Insert	Formulas	Data	Review	View	Automate	
B4	=IFERROR((Actual-Budget)/Budget,0)						
Account	Budget	Actual	Variance	Variance %	Check	Owner	
Revenue	1,200,000	1,265,000	65,000	5.4%	OK	FP&A	
Payroll	420,000	437,500	17,500	4.2%	Review	HR	
Cloud services	86,000	102,000	16,000	18.6%	Review	IT	
Marketing	160,000	149,000	-11,000	-6.9%	OK	Growth	
Travel	55,000	82,000	27,000	49.1%	Action	Ops	
Transparent logic D4 = C4 - B4 E4 = IFERROR(D4/B4,0) Mini verification checklist ● Reconcile totals ● Cross-check a sample ● Check units and signs ● Confirm assumptions							

Rights note

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How to Use This Handbook

This is a working reference rather than a document to read once and set aside. Use the structure below to move quickly from learning to application.

1. Select the level	Start with foundations, data and numbers, prompting, custom AI or CFO strategy.
2. Apply one tip	Use the guidance on a current finance task and produce an auditable output.
3. Verify the result	Reconcile totals, validate formulas, check assumptions and confirm definitions.
4. Standardise the workflow	Convert useful prompts and logic into reusable team assets with clear ownership.

BSOE Finance Workbook

Data readiness and auditability

Home

Insert

Formulas

Data

Review

View

Automate

B4

=IFERROR((Actual-Budget)/Budget,0)

Before: presentation-style data

Quarterly Finance Summary

Merged cells | multiple values | manual subtotals

Revenue £1.2m / 8%

Costs £780k / 6%

Margin £420k / 13%

Notes: see email thread

After: AI-ready table

Date	Account	Entity	Currency	Amount	Scenario
31/03	Revenue	UK	GBP	1,200,000	Actual
31/03	Payroll	UK	GBP	420,000	Actual
31/03	Cloud	UK	GBP	86,000	Actual
30/06	Revenue	UK	GBP	1,310,000	Forecast
30/06	Payroll	UK	GBP	438,000	Forecast

One variable per column • one transaction per row • consistent formats

Handbook Architecture

The handbook progresses from safe individual use to organisation-wide finance transformation.

Level 1	Real AI foundations for finance	Safety, tools, data structure and auditable outputs
Level 2	Data & numbers	Analysis, modelling, dashboards, cleaning and advanced workflows
Level 3	Prompting mastery	Structured prompts, guardrails, formats and iterative methods
Level 4	Custom AI	Design, knowledge, governance, ownership and quality control
Level 5	AI CFO	Roadmaps, portfolio management, stakeholder influence and adoption

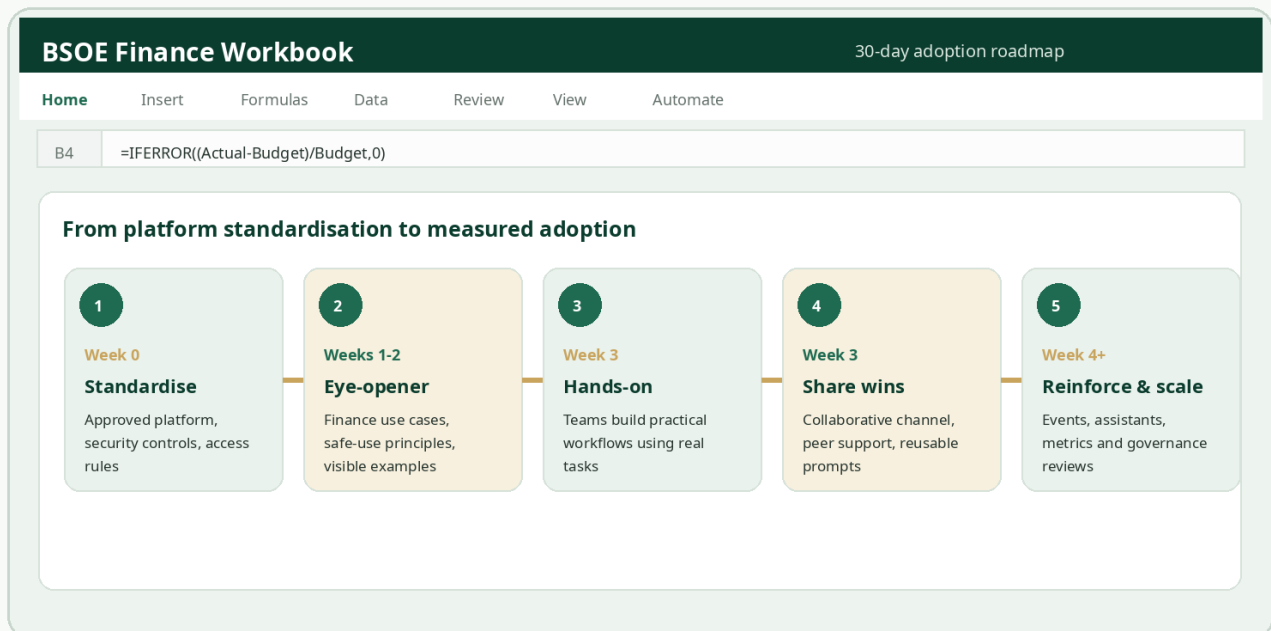


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LEVEL 1 - REAL AI FOUNDATIONS FOR FINANCE

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Travel	55,000	82,000	27,000	49.1%	Action	Ops

Transparent logic

D4 = C4 - B4

E4 = IFERROR(D4/B4,0)

Mini verification checklist

- Reconcile totals
- Cross-check a sample
- Check units and signs
- Confirm assumptions

Consider level 1 as the executive summary and essentials of what you should remember from this guide. This level is designed for readers who want the essential guidance and may not have time to review all 100 tips. Use it as a five-minute executive summary and bookmark the ten most important tips.

1. AI Is Probabilistic, Not Deterministic

AI models are probabilistic. This means they predict the most likely response based on patterns learned from data, not on guaranteed facts or fixed rules. As a result, their outputs can sometimes be inconsistent, imprecise, or even incorrect - especially in financial analysis, where accuracy matters.

Because of this, AI should not be treated as a "calculator" or a final decision-maker.

To use AI safely and effectively in finance, the key principle is simple: do not ask AI to give you the final answer - ask it to give you something you can audit. Don't treat AI output as final without an audit trail.

Best practice for finance professionals

Ask AI to produce auditable artifacts, not just "answers":

- Excel formulas (transparent logic you can inspect and reconcile)

- Python/SQL code (step-by-step logic you can test and reuse)

Both Excel formulas and Python code are deterministic. You can audit, validate, reuse, and even productize them within your organization.

Practical finance example

- Instead of asking AI to calculate a valuation or forecast directly
- Ask it to build an Excel file with clearly structured formulas
- Or request Python code that performs the calculation step by step

This approach transforms AI into a powerful assistant that accelerates your work while maintaining control over accuracy, compliance, and decision-making.

Mini verification checklist

- Reconcile totals to a trusted source (GL, trial balance, subledger)
- Run "sanity checks" (units, time periods, currency, signs)
- Cross-check with a second method (e.g., pivot vs formula vs query)
- Write down assumptions and confirm definitions (e.g., "gross margin")

2. Decide How You Handle Confidential Data Before You Prompt

Before using any AI tool, you must first decide what type of data you are allowed to share. This decision should be made before uploading files, pasting text, or running analysis.

Tier 1 - Public data

- Information that is already public or non-sensitive
- Safe to use across most AI tools

Tier 2 - Internal data

- Non-public company information intended for internal use only
- Requires clear rules on which AI tools are approved
- Should only be used with tools that meet your organization's security standards

Tier 3 - Confidential and critical data

- Highly sensitive information such as financial results, client data, contracts, or strategic plans
- Requires strict control over both the AI tool and user access
- Must only be processed using enterprise-grade, security-compliant AI solutions

For Tier 2 and Tier 3 data, it is essential to understand whether your AI tools provide enterprise-grade security, including clear policies on data retention, access control, and model training.

You can confirm (with IT/security/legal as appropriate):

- Data usage/training defaults: The first and most critical question is how your data is used by the AI provider. Verify:
 - Whether your prompts, files, and outputs are used to train AI models
 - Whether training is enabled by default or opt-out
 - Whether enterprise plans guarantee no training on your data
- Retention controls: Understand what happens to your data after you use the tool. Verify:
 - How long prompts, files, and outputs are stored
 - Whether data retention can be configured or shortened
 - Whether you can permanently delete data on demand
 - Whether backups or logs also retain sensitive content
- Admin controls (SSO, user management, auditability): AI tools should be governed like any other enterprise system. Verify:
 - Single Sign-On (SSO) support
 - User provisioning and de-provisioning
 - Role-based access controls
 - Audit logs showing who accessed what and when
- Connector controls (which systems can be connected): Connectors dramatically increase AI power - but also risk. Verify:
 - Which systems can be connected (Drive, email, ERP, CRM, databases)
 - Whether connectors are opt-in or enabled by default
 - Who can authorize new connections
 - Whether access is read-only or can modify data

3. Choose a Tool + License Based on Ecosystem and Data Tier

At Level 1, tool selection is often less about "smartest model" and more about - what your organization already uses (Microsoft 365 vs Google Workspace vs standalone); what data you need to touch (Tier 1 vs Tier 2/3); what IT can govern and support.

Pick the tool that:

1. Fits your ecosystem (Microsoft or Google heavy users often benefit from native integration)
2. Matches your data tier (Tier 2/3 -> business/enterprise-grade controls)
3. Your IT/security team will approve and support long-term

3.1 Standalone AI - best for Individuals and Small Businesses

3.1.1 ChatGPT

For Tier 2/3 work, prefer business-grade workspaces and follow your internal policy. OpenAI states business products are not used for training by default (unless opted in). If you're using personal plans, data sharing/training controls differ and may be enabled by default, review settings carefully.

Licensing details

- Consumer versions (Free/Go/Plus/Pro) are suitable for non-sensitive, personal use (you can disable training in settings)
- ChatGPT Business or Enterprise licenses are best suited for confidential and sensitive data as it ensures data privacy, security, and compliance (training is disabled by default) - more of their privacy commitments

Level of data integration

- This is a conversation-first AI, interaction is inside ChatGPT (with Apps/Connectors)
- Manual upload + links, plus connected sources like Google Drive and SharePoint within ChatGPT conversations using internal Connectors (full list of Apps)
- Tends to be most flexible across many external/3rd-party tools because it supports a broad set of connectors/apps and admin controls for enabling them

Core strengths

- Flexible reasoning + writing in one place, strong for turning messy finance questions into structured outputs (memos, narratives, checklists, model critique)
- Has built-in data analysis workflow (e.g., working with tables/files, generating code for analysis in a secure execution environment)
- Cross-platform connectors can pull context from multiple external systems (e.g., Drive/SharePoint/etc.) from within ChatGPT
- Fast to deploy for individuals/teams, great when you want a single "thinking partner" that can work across different task types and formats

Best finance uses

- Variance commentary drafts (with your reconciled numbers)
- Scenario narratives + risk registers
- Building auditable artifacts (Excel formula logic, SQL, Python)

3.1.2 Claude

For Tier 2/3 work, prefer Claude for Work (Team/Enterprise) (or Claude via the Anthropic API / Bedrock / Vertex) and follow internal policy. Anthropic states that inputs/outputs from its commercial products are not used for model training by default (unless opted in). If you're using consumer Claude plans (Free/Pro/Max), data sharing/training controls differ and can change retention (up to 5 years if you allow training), so review privacy settings carefully.

Licensing details

- Consumer versions (Free/Pro/Max): suitable for non-sensitive, personal use. On consumer plans, you may be prompted to allow chats/coding sessions to be used for model training; if you allow it, Anthropic extends retention to up to five years, while if you don't, retention stays at 30 days
- Claude for Work (Team/Enterprise): for Tier 2/3 work, use Team/Enterprise so IT can manage access and governance - more of their privacy commitments

Level of data integration

- This is a conversation-first AI (like ChatGPT): you work inside Claude, then pull context from connected systems
- Pre-built connectors include Google and Microsoft surfaces (e.g., Google Drive, Gmail/Google Calendar, Slack, GitHub, and Microsoft 365 via a dedicated connector), see more about Connectors
- If your org prefers cloud-governed deployments, Claude is also available via Amazon Bedrock and Google Cloud Vertex AI (useful when procurement/security wants it inside existing cloud controls)
- Claude also supports building custom connectors through Anthropic's connectors framework (MCP-related options are documented in their connectors help center)

Core strengths

- Long-context analysis + synthesis - strong for consolidating lots of finance text (policies, contracts, board materials, threads) into structured outputs
- Admin/usage controls for scaling - Team/Enterprise include admin controls like spend caps, seat management, and usage analytics (useful for governance and adoption tracking)
- Cross-ecosystem - can connect into Microsoft 365 and Google services, but the workflow stays primarily inside Claude (vs. in-app AI like Copilot/Gemini)

Best finance uses

- Board-pack and memo compression
- Policy interpretation + controls mapping
- Audit-ready artifacts (assumptions log, decision record, reconciliation narratives)

3.2 Microsoft 365 Copilot - best when your work already lives in Microsoft 365

Use it when your work is already built around Excel/Outlook/Teams and you want AI inside those workflows.

Licensing details

- Copilot is an add-on that requires an eligible base license. Examples include Business Basic/Standard/Premium and many business/enterprise plans. See a much more detailed list of plans

Level of data integration

- Copilot can be accessed inside Microsoft 365 Apps (depending on the license/inclusion)

- It can access your organization's data embedded inside your apps, so they're designed to work on the same documents/emails/chats you already use
- It can ingest external content via Copilot connectors into Microsoft Graph and surface it with citations

Core strengths

- Deep in-app productivity, works inside Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook, Teams so users stay in the flow of work
- Grounded in your org data, designed to be securely grounded in your work context across Microsoft 365
- Enterprise extensibility via connectors, ingest line-of-business and third-party data into Microsoft Graph using Copilot connectors, expanding what Copilot can reason over
- Strong for executive-ready outputs - especially PowerPoint/Word workflows that finance teams often need for board packs and leadership reporting

Best finance uses

- Turning Excel analysis into an exec summary + PowerPoint narrative
- Drafting AR/AP follow-ups from Outlook context
- "Find the file / thread / meeting notes" across Microsoft 365, then summarize
- Make the Researcher agent in Copilot prepare your week by gathering all the information across Outlook, Teams and your OneDrive. This is the equivalent of having your executive assistant which would have worked half a day to prepare this... but now it's done while you go and prepare your coffee on Monday morning.

3.3 Google Workspace with Gemini - best when your work already lives in Google Workspace

Use it when your finance workflow is already built around Google Workspace Apps and you want AI inside those workflows.

Licensing details

- Paying for Google Workspace Business/Enterprise generally includes Gemini (no separate add-on needed), but what you get depends on your edition and your admin settings. More details about this

Level of data integration

- Gemini can be accessed inside Google Workspace apps (depending on the license/inclusion)
- It can access your Workspace content across services, admins can enable/disable per service and it can reference items across services
- Primarily Google-first, integration focuses on Workspace services

Core strengths

- In-app help via the side panel - Gemini supports summarizing, analyzing, and generating content using insights from email messages, documents, and more without switching apps/tabs

- Strong for communication-heavy workflows - Gmail-first teams benefit from fast drafting, summarization, and locating context across Drive/Docs/Sheets
- Admin controls per service where admins can enable/disable Gemini features by Workspace service; even if turned off in one service, users can still ask about items from another service

Best finance uses

- Summarizing vendor threads and pulling the right Drive files quickly
- Drafting budget request responses and policy emails
- Turning meeting notes into action items and follow-ups

Final Recommendations

- Choose one AI tool aligned with your existing ecosystem to avoid "analysis paralysis" - the risk that multiple options will cause users to delay or avoid adopting AI
- Free or low-tier AI licenses are insufficient for business use involving sensitive data
- Integration with existing ecosystems is critical factor in selecting AI tools
- Need a cross-tool "universal workbench" (Drive + SharePoint + other apps) -> ChatGPT connectors are often the most cross-platform, but the workflow centers in ChatGPT
- Primarily in Excel/Outlook/Teams -> Copilot has the deepest "in-place" integration
- Primarily in Gmail/Drive/Docs/Sheets -> Gemini for Workspace usually has the deepest "in-place" integration
- Enterprise-grade security and data privacy are essential when using AI for confidential business information
- Avoid spreading AI tool usage across multiple platforms to prevent confusion and underutilization

4. Use Reasoning Modes for Decisions, Fast Modes for Drafts

Most AI platforms offer multiple modes (of the same model or different model) optimized either for speed or for deeper reasoning. Not every mode fits every task. The names may change across products, but the principle stays the same: use fast modes for drafting and reasoning modes for analysis and decisions.

Fast modes are designed for speed and fluency

- Best for writing emails, fixing grammar, and drafting text
- Provide quick responses with minimal computational reasoning

Reasoning (or thinking) modes are designed for accuracy and depth

- Better for financial analysis, Excel models, and code generation
- Built to handle complex problems that require structured thinking

4.1 ChatGPT Model Selection

4.2 Claude Model Selection

4.3 Copilot Model Selection

4.4 Gemini Model Selection

For real business decisions, speed is less important than correctness. This is where reasoning models outperform fast models.

5. CSI+FBI Prompting Framework

The quality of AI-generated results varies depending on how you frame your questions. A prompt technique is a structured approach or methodology used to craft instructions for an AI model. It's more than just asking a question. It's about strategically designing your input to guide the AI towards generating a more precise, relevant, and high-quality output.

Two core prompting strategies are used in this handbook.

The CSI and CSI+FBI methods.

CSI (Context, Specific, Instruction)

Tell the AI who you are (Context), what the exact problem is (Specific), and what you need it to do (Instruction).

- Context: Providing enough context so that the LLM can understand the task's background
- Specific: Clearly define the exact problem or focus to eliminate ambiguity. Make sure to explain your problem with specificity.
- Instruction: Tell the model what to do or the 'task' you want it to execute.

Example Prompt:

I am a finance manager for a digital banking company, my boss wants a cost reduction plan,

can you create a practical and realistic plan?

FBI (Format, Blueprint, Identity)

This extension adds more context and direction to the AI prompt. You can see that there is format, blueprint, and identity (optional) added.

- Context: Define your role and setting.
- Specificity: Clearly articulate the problem.
- Instruction: Specify what output you want.
- Format: Ask for charts, tables, or scripts as needed.

- Blueprint: Add constraints or examples.
- Identity: Assign a persona or expertise level to the AI (e.g., "act as a McKinsey consultant").

Example Prompt:

I am a finance manager for a digital banking company, my boss wants a cost reduction plan, can you create a practical and realistic plan?

Your output needs to be in a table format. In a table, show quick-win actions and a column for a 5-step plan. Create this as an experienced cost-reduction consultant.

6. Structure Your Data To Make It AI-Ready

BSOE Finance Workbook

Data readiness and auditability

Home

Insert

Formulas

Data

Review

View

Automate

B4

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Before: presentation-style data

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30/06	Revenue	UK	GBP	1,310,000	Forecast
30/06	Payroll	UK	GBP	438,000	Forecast

One variable per column • one transaction per row • consistent formats

AI performs best when it works with structured, machine-readable data. One of the most common reasons for poor AI outputs is not the model itself, but rather the way the data is prepared.

What AI-friendly data looks like

- Data organized in clear columns with one variable per column
- Transactions listed in rows, one transaction per line
- Consistent formats for dates, numbers, currencies, and categories

What to avoid

- Summary tables built for presentations
- Merged cells, subtotals, and decorative formatting
- Multiple values combined in a single cell

Best data sources for AI analysis

- Raw transactional data extracted directly from ERP systems
- System-generated tables from accounting, billing, or CRM platforms
- Clean datasets that reflect actual business processes

7. Chunk Your Work

AI has limits in how much information it can process effectively at once. When you ask AI to handle very large or complex tasks in a single prompt, the results are often incomplete, shallow, or overly generic.

When dealing with large datasets or long reports, break the information into smaller "chunks" for input or request the output in parts.

How to apply chunking

- Do not ask AI to solve a big problem in one prompt.
- Breaking large tasks into smaller, manageable pieces
- Asking AI to focus on one clearly defined task at a time
- Moving to the next step only after reviewing and validating the previous output

Example Prompt:

My R&D budget has overrun. Break down the potential causes and suggest targeted strategies

to address each. Only answer one cause at a time.

8. Don't Put AI in the Critical Path of Recurring Automations

A common misconception is that AI can automate everything simply by "throwing the problem at it." In reality, this approach often creates unstable, non-repeatable processes.

Most finance workflows are deterministic. If you consolidate data, calculate KPIs, or generate reports, the logic is usually the same every month. These tasks should run the same way every time.

Because of this, don't put AI in the middle of recurring automations - use AI to automate the workflow.

The right approach

- Use AI to write automation scripts, not to execute the process each time
- Convert AI output into deterministic logic such as Excel formulas, Python scripts, or SQL queries
- Run the same script repeatedly without relying on AI after it is created

9. Reusable Instruction Blocks (System/Master Prompt Technique)

Many people run into the same pattern: you spend time iterating-tweaking instructions, correcting outputs, and refining prompts-until the AI finally produces what you wanted from the start.

That iteration is valuable, but repeating it every time is inefficient.

A reusable System/Master Prompt captures the "winning" instructions once, so you can reuse them consistently. You'll see both terms used:

- System prompt usually refers to the highest-priority instruction
- Master prompt is often a name for your reusable prompt template (your saved "recipe"), regardless of where you place it

The goal is simple: next time you want the same kind of result, you start with this saved prompt and get there in fewer iterations-often in one shot.

How the system/master prompt technique works

- After reaching a high-quality final output, ask AI: "What would be the system/master prompt to get this result on the first go next time?"
- AI generates a structured prompt that summarizes your entire conversation; defines the role, context, rules, and output format

Two ways to use the system/master prompt

- Save the system/master prompt in a document and reuse it manually whenever you need the same type of output
- Paste the system/master prompt into a custom GPT, Gemini Gem, or Copilot agent to get consistent results

10. Build Custom Assistants (GPTs / Artifacts / Agents / Gems)

Many people consider themselves advanced AI users because they know how to write good prompts. In practice, truly advanced users go one step further: they turn prompts into reusable AI tools.

Custom GPTs, Claude Artifacts, Copilot Agents, and Gemini Gems are still heavily underused even by experienced AI users. Yet they are one of the most effective ways to save time and scale your productivity.

What custom AI agents are

- Pre-configured AI assistants with fixed instructions and behavior
- Designed to remove repetitive prompting & perform recurring tasks consistently

General steps to build a Custom GPT/Gem/Agent

1. Open the builder:

- In ChatGPT: Go to "Explore" -> "Create a GPT"
- In Claude: Go to "Artifacts" -> "New Artifact"
- In Gemini: Go to "Gems" -> "New Gem"
- In Copilot: Go to "Agents" -> "Create Agent"

2. Configure: 2.1. Configure Instructions (role, rules, output structure, etc.) 2.2. Add Knowledge if needed (templates, examples, SOPs, reference documents) 2.3. Set Capabilities (enable only what is necessary) 2.4. Name the agent, test it with real scenarios, refine, and save

LEVEL 2 - DATA & NUMBERS

BSOE Finance Workbook
Data readiness and auditability

HomeInsertFormulasDataReviewViewAutomate

B4=IFERROR((Actual-Budget)/Budget,0)

Before: presentation-style data

Quarterly Finance Summary

Merged cells | multiple values | manual subtotals

Revenue	£1.2m / 8%
Costs	£780k / 6%
Margin	£420k / 13%
Notes: see email thread	

After: AI-ready table

Date	Account	Entity	Currency	Amount	Scenario
31/03	Revenue	UK	GBP	1,200,000	Actual
31/03	Payroll	UK	GBP	420,000	Actual
31/03	Cloud	UK	GBP	86,000	Actual
30/06	Revenue	UK	GBP	1,310,000	Forecast
30/06	Payroll	UK	GBP	438,000	Forecast

One variable per column • one transaction per row • consistent formats

GROUP 1: FINANCIAL ANALYSIS

AI can dramatically accelerate financial analysis - but only if you treat AI like a junior analyst and give it a clear, multi-step plan. I've shown this tip in one of my YouTube videos on how to use AI in 2026.

You can check it out in this link: [3 Practical Ways to Use AI as a Finance Pro in 2026](#)

is my 5-Step Analysis Workflow for Financial Analysis:

- Step 1: Use "Thinking Mode", upload your data and ask to check for consistency of data
- Step 2: Ask to think about these 4 types of analysis (descriptive, diagnostic, predictive, prescriptive)
- Step 3: Calculate and show the calculation
- Step 4: Create visuals for each analysis
- Step 5: Create commentaries like a seasoned CFO

Then iterate to achieve the desired output.

Example Prompt:

I am the CFO of a supermarket. I want to increase sales. are your tasks:

Step 1: Verify consistency of data

Step 2: Propose the analysis (3 descriptive, 2 diagnostic, 2 predictive, 2 prescriptive)

based on the data provided and your goal

Step 3: Perform the analysis and detail the calculations

Step 4: Show the visuals for each analysis

Step 5: Create the commentaries like a "seasoned CFO"

Iterate

The following tips describe each step in the 5-Step Analysis Workflow, guiding you from raw data to executive-level insights.

11. Ask AI to Check the Consistency of the Data First

Before running any analysis, always validate the data. Analysis based on inconsistent or incorrect data leads to incorrect conclusions, regardless of how advanced the model is.

- Ask AI to review the dataset for missing values, duplicates, inconsistencies, etc.
- Use a reasoning or thinking model for this step
- Confirm that totals, dates, currencies, and categories make sense before proceeding

Building up this habit ensures that every analysis starts from a reliable foundation.

12. Ask AI to Think Across the Four Types of Analysis

Do not ask AI to "analyze the data" in general terms. Instead, explicitly guide it to apply the four key types of financial analysis.

- Descriptive (What happened?)
- Predictive (What will happen?)
- Diagnostic (Why did it happen?)
- Prescriptive (What should we do?)

Structuring the analysis this way boosts depth, relevance, and decision value by pushing the AI into more advanced predictive and prescriptive work (normally AI doesn't do it without asking for it).

13. Ask AI to Calculate and Show the Calculations

Never accept results without visibility into the logic behind them.

- Ask AI to calculate metrics step by step
- Request formulas, tables, or code that clearly show how results are derived
- Ensure outputs are auditable and reproducible

This approach keeps AI accountable and allows you to audit the outputs.

14. Use the "Spot Check" Method to Audit AI Outputs

You do not need to recheck every number AI produces. Instead, apply the Spot Check method to verify accuracy efficiently while keeping full control over critical outputs.

Step 1: Ask AI to show its full logic

- Request calculations in an auditable format (Python code, Excel formulas, etc.)
- Ensure assumptions and intermediate steps are visible

Step 2: Review the logic, not just the result

- Check whether the formulas and calculations make business sense
- Look for incorrect joins, missing filters, or inconsistent assumptions

Step 3: Manually verify high-risk calculations

- Select one or two complex or high-impact metrics
- Recalculate them manually or in Excel to confirm correctness

Step 4: Ask AI to audit itself

Use a second prompt such as:

Review your own analysis and highlight any inconsistencies, outliers, or potential errors.

Bonus tip:

If you get Python code and you don't understand, do not panic and do not give up.

Instead, use AI to help you audit it and document how the code works.

This is how you can ensure the accuracy and good documentation of the calculation.

15. Ask AI to Create Visuals for Each Analysis

Data is best understood visually (especially for us humans).

- Ask AI to create appropriate visuals for each type of analysis
- Use charts to support insights, not just decorate reports
- Review visuals to ensure they accurately reflect the underlying data

Well-designed visuals improve both understanding and communication with stakeholders.

One tip: ask which graph would be the best for your financial storytelling.

16. Ask AI to Write Commentaries Like a Seasoned CFO

Numbers alone do not drive decisions. Executives, boards, and stakeholders need interpretation, not spreadsheets.

If you use the word "seasoned" your commentaries will immediately increase in quality.

With this technique, AI can help you transform raw analysis into clear, decision-ready commentary-if you prompt it correctly.

- Ask AI to write financial commentary in the tone of an experienced CFO
- Focus on key drivers, implications, risks, and recommended actions
- Translate analysis into business language, not technical jargon

This final step turns analysis into insight and insight into action.

GROUP 2: CREATE FINANCIAL MODELS

AI can accelerate financial modeling when guided with the right structure & assumptions. The goal isn't to replace judgment, but to reduce manual work while keeping control over judgment and outcomes.

I have talked about this in one of my YouTube videos on how to use AI (like ChatGPT) to build financial models.

You can watch it by clicking the link : [How to Use ChatGPT 5 to Build INSANE Financial Models](#)

17. Use a Thinking or Reasoning Model

Financial modeling requires structure and logic. When you ask AI to build or check a model, you want a model that can follow multi-step reasoning (assumptions -> calculations -> checks -> outputs), not one optimized for speed or polished text.

To understand the difference between a fast or reasoning model, you can check back in Tip 4.

Use a reasoning / thinking model first because it:

- Handles chained calculations and dependencies more reliably

- Is better at spotting inconsistencies (units, signs, time periods, circularity)
- Produces more robust, auditable logic (clear steps you can verify)

Choosing the right model type is the foundation of reliable financial modeling.

18. Give Specific Assumptions

AI cannot guess how your business works or how you plan. Your assumptions define the model.

- Clearly define key assumptions such as growth rates, cost drivers, pricing, or timelines
- Be specific enough to guide the model
- Avoid writing overly long explanations or theoretical descriptions

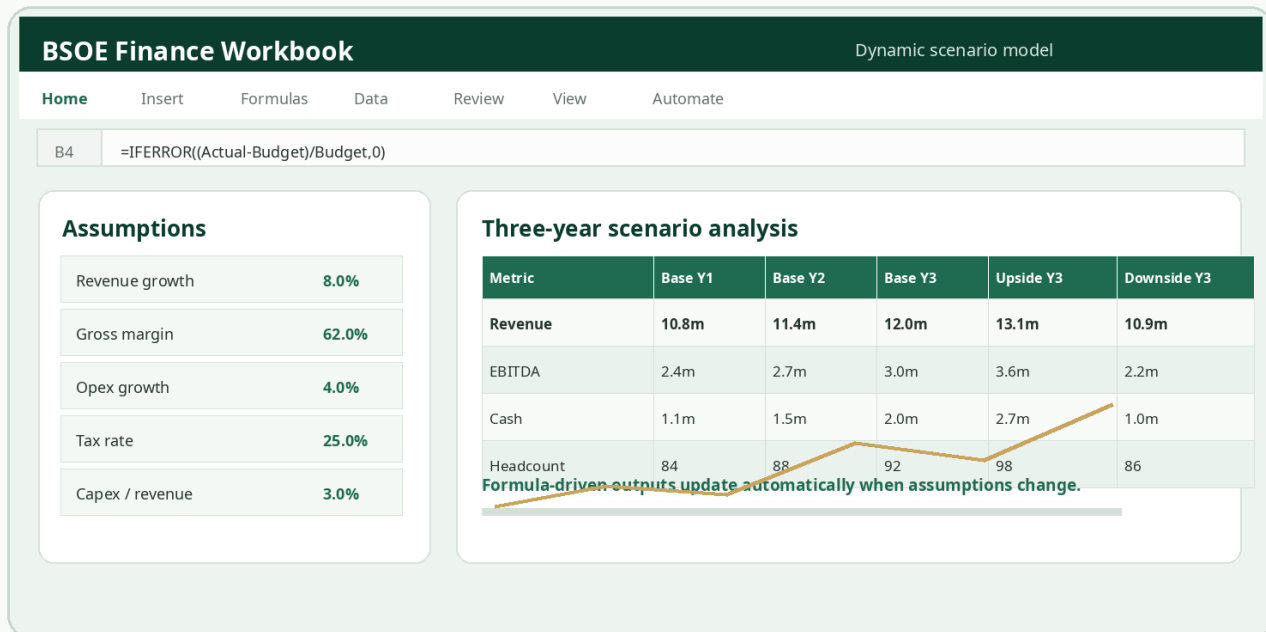
Good assumptions lead to useful models; vague assumptions lead to noise.

Example Prompt:

Build a 3-year financial model using the following assumptions:

- Revenue growth: 8% year 1, 6% year 2, 5% year 3
- Gross margin: 62%, stable
- Operating expenses grow at 4% annually
- Capex: 3% of revenue
- Corporate tax rate: 25%

19. Ask AI to Create a Model with Formulas in Excel



A financial model must be auditable and reusable.

- Ask AI to build a model using explicit formulas
- Request the model directly in Excel format
- Review and validate the logic before using it

Example Prompt:

None

Create a 3-year financial model in Excel based on the assumptions below.

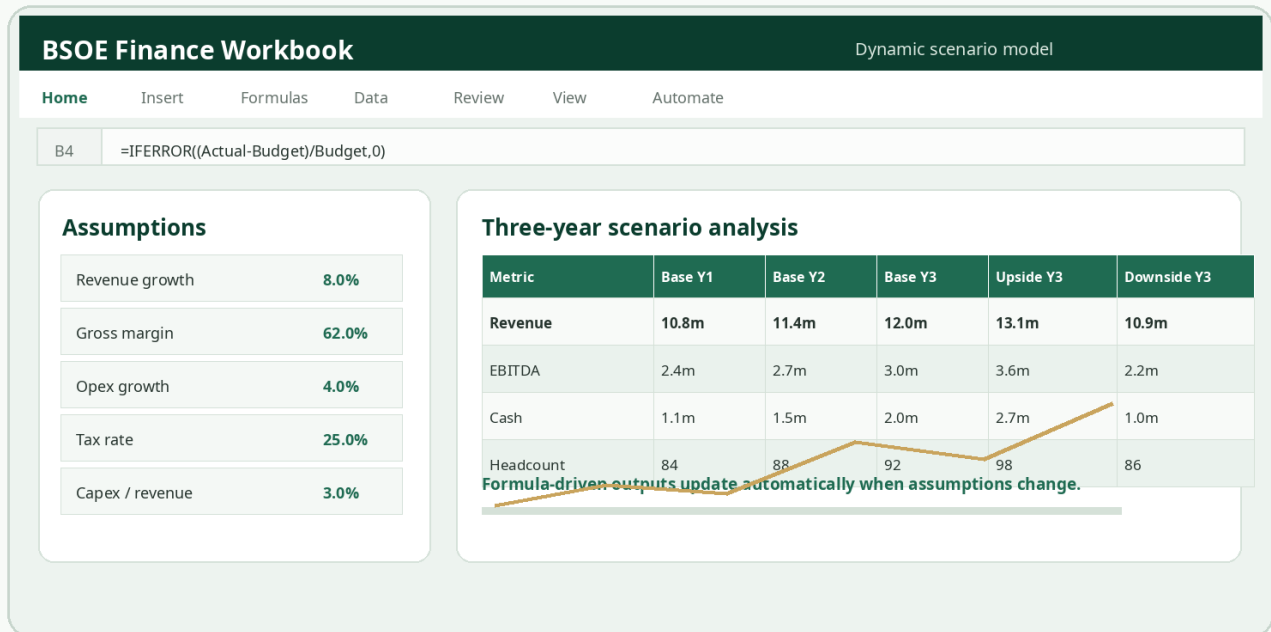
Requirements:

- Use explicit Excel formulas in cells
- Separate Inputs, Calculations, and Outputs
- Deliver the result as a downloadable Excel file

Assumptions:

- Revenue growth: 8% / 6% / 5%
- Gross margin: 62%
- Operating expenses grow at 4%
- Tax rate: 25%

20. Ask AI to Create a Scenario Analysis Tool Using Canvas



Once the base model is validated, do not stop there.

- Ask AI to create a scenario tool in Canvas after the model is ready
- Request an interactive interface (often HTML-based) that presents key outputs clearly
- Review the tool, then iterate until it matches how you want to present results

This step transforms a static model into a decision-support interface.

21. Ask AI to Make the Tool Dynamic

Dynamic models enable teams to align quickly and agree on a scenario during discussions.

- Ask AI to make assumptions adjustable in real time (sliders, inputs, dropdowns, or editable fields)
- Ask it to update outputs automatically when assumptions change
- Use this setup in meetings to test scenarios and answer questions on the spot

Example Prompt to Create Financial Forecasting Mini-App:

Create a React app with a simple form where I can input revenue, growth rate, and

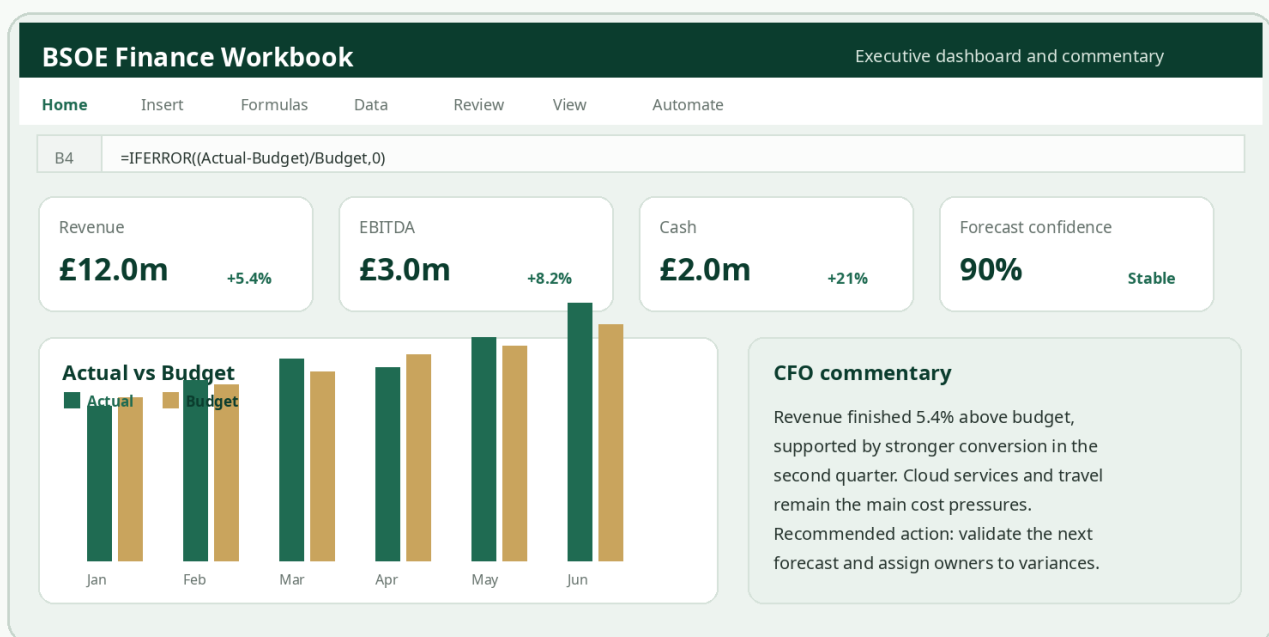
expenses, and it outputs a 5-year forecast chart (line chart for revenue and bar chart for

profit). Make it editable so I can test scenarios.

GROUP 3: CREATE DASHBOARD

Once your analysis and financial models are ready, the next step is turning them into dashboards and reporting assets. The key is using Canvas, a feature that enables AI to generate structured outputs, such as dashboards or slides, directly from your analysis.

22. Use Canvas in ChatGPT to Build Dashboards



Canvas is a workspace inside ChatGPT where you can create, edit, and iterate on long-form documents or code. Unlike normal chat, it opens up a side panel where the generated content lives.

How to Activate Canvas

- Activate Canvas by clicking the "+" icon in ChatGPT
- Select "More" -> "Canvas" to enable the interactive coding environment
- Enter your prompts

What you can create

- Code-based tools -> financial calculators, forecasting models, dashboards, APIs
- Reports & docs -> investment memos, board reports, financial writeups
- Presentations -> HTML slide decks, interactive dashboards, styled outputs

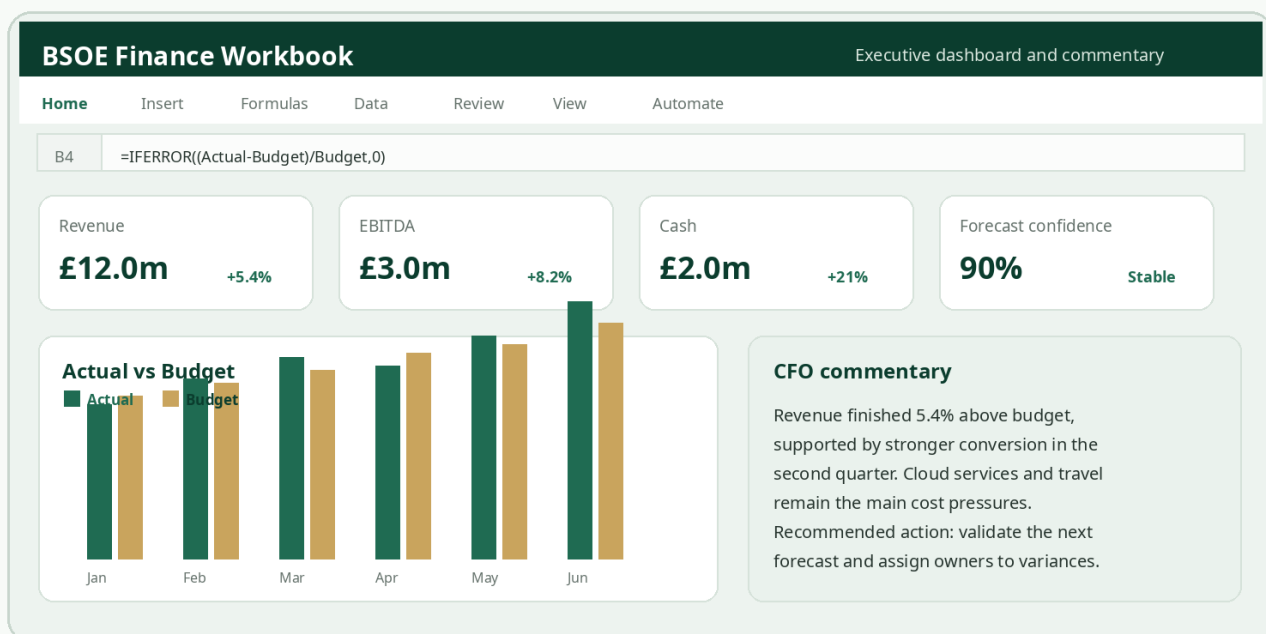
Example Prompt for Scenario Modelling Dashboard:

Build me a Python app that allows me to model three scenarios (best case, base case, worst case) for a

company's EBITDA, given assumptions for revenue growth, COGS %, and SG&A %. Display the outputs in a

table and a chart.

23. Ask for Dashboards in HTML



Dashboards are best generated in a structured format. Because it's HTML, you could tweak it directly. Locate the number in the code, replace it, and then refresh. You have full flexibility, no design skills required.

This is a massive upgrade from traditional reporting tools. You're no longer stuck in PowerPoint or PDF formats. You can create modern, web-ready reports that are easy to share, embed, or even automate into recurring workflows.

- After complete the analysis, ask AI to create a HTML dashboard using your completed analysis
- Let AI structure sections, charts, and key metrics logically
- Review the output to ensure numbers, visuals, and logic are correct
- Export this HTML and open it in any browser, embed it in emails and presentations, or hand off to technical teams if needed.

Example Prompt:

Generate a clean HTML slide deck with 5 slides summarizing financial performance: 1)

Title, 2) Revenue growth trend, 3) Expense breakdown pie chart, 4) Forecast vs Actual bar

chart, 5) Key risks and assumptions. Style it with Tailwind for a professional look.

24. Use Canvas in Gemini

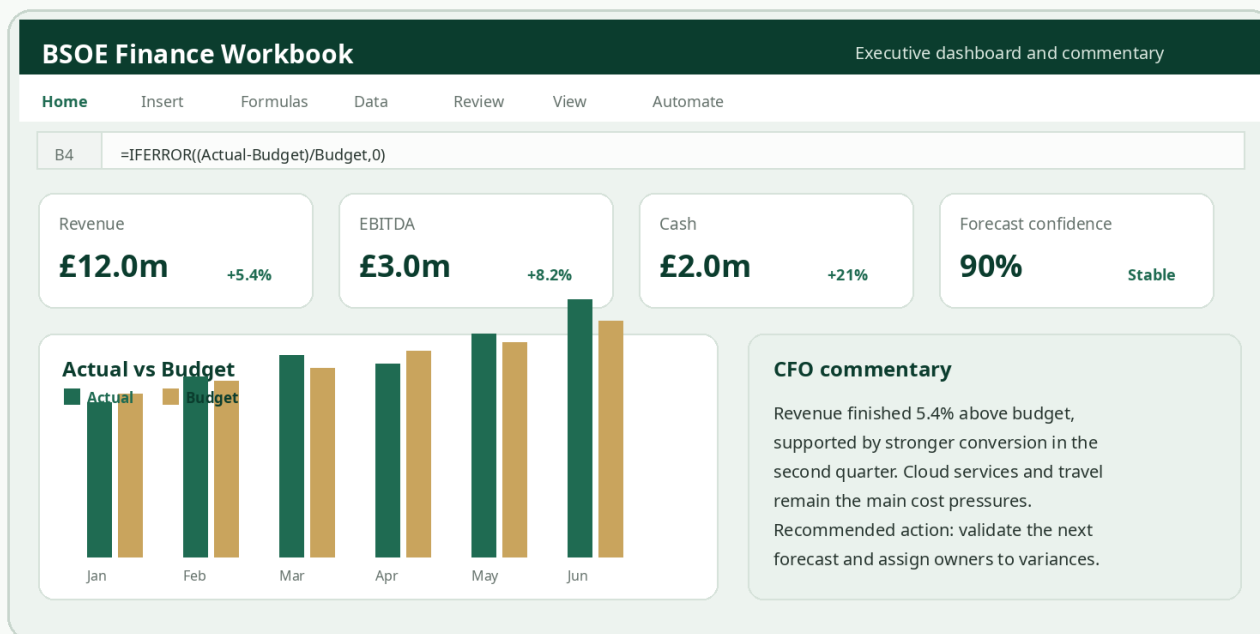
Gemini also provides a Canvas-like environment for creating structured outputs.

- Use Gemini's Canvas after completing your analysis
- Treat it as a production layer for dashboards or slides
- Leverage its native integration with Google Workspace

How to Activate Canvas

- Activate Canvas by clicking the "Tools" dropdown
- Select "Canvas" to activate
- Enter your prompts

25. Create Dashboards with Gemini



Gemini can use your analysis to generate dashboards directly.

- Ask Gemini to turn your analysis into a dashboard layout
- Let it structure insights, visuals, and key takeaways
- Review and refine the dashboard before sharing

This approach is significantly faster than traditional BI development cycles.

Example Prompt for Forecasting Simulator Dashboard:

Vibe code a single-file, responsive HTML application with embedded JavaScript.

This app is a Driver-Based Forecasting Simulator for a SaaS company. It should have three

input sliders on the left:

- New Customer Acquisition (YoY %): (Range 5% to 30%)
- Churn Rate: (Range 1% to 8%)
- Average Subscription Price (ASP) Change: (Range -5% to +10%)

The main dashboard on the right should display calculated outputs based on a starting

baseline of 10,000 customers and a \$100 ASP. Show the resulting Annual Recurring Revenue

(ARR) and Customer Lifetime Value (CLV) in bold. Include a simple line chart that visually

tracks the ARR over the next 12 months based on the slider inputs. Use Tailwind CSS for a

professional, centered layout.

26. Create Slides with Gemini

Beyond dashboards, Gemini can also generate presentation-ready slides. This allows you to move from analysis to executive-ready presentation in a single workflow.

- Ask Gemini to create slides from your analysis using Canvas
- Slides are generated directly in Google Slides
- Use them as a first draft, then refine visuals and messaging

Example Prompt:

Create a presentation explaining Capex and Opex for non-finance professionals.

When downloaded, the presentation is converted into a PDF. When exported to Slides, it can be editable

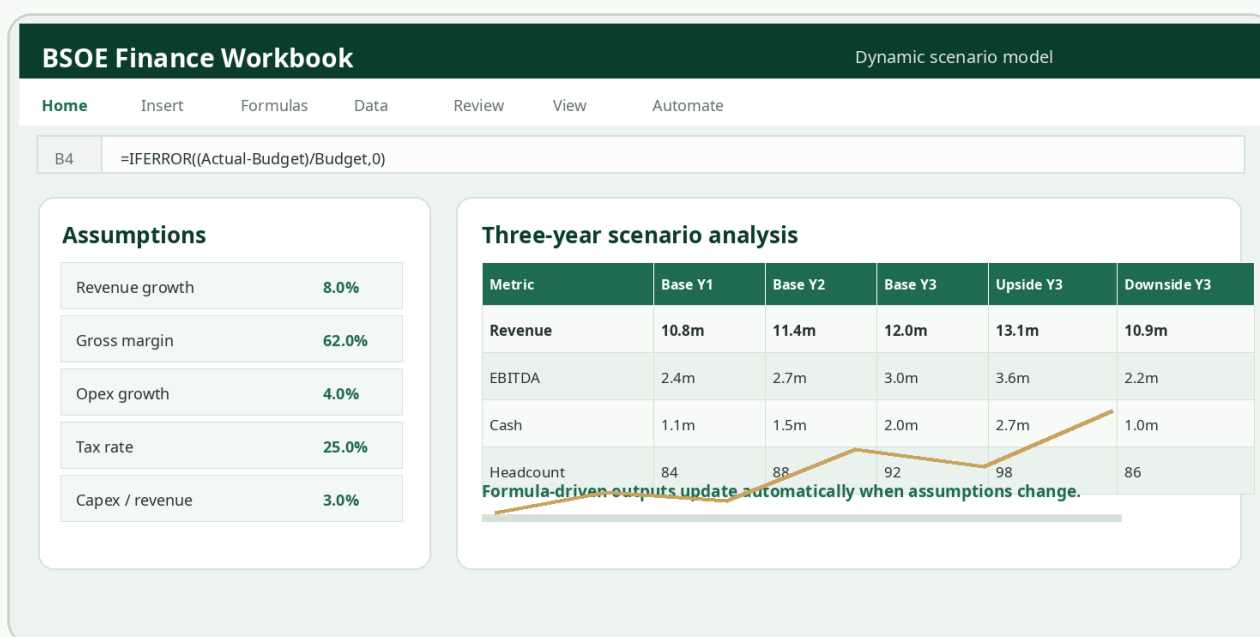
(except for the images, like graphs or illustrations generated)

GROUP 4: AUTOMATE DATA CLEANING

Data preparation is one of the most time-consuming parts of finance work. Cleaning files, consolidating data, transforming formats, and auditing numbers often take hours every month.

With AI, you no longer need to learn how to code to automate these tasks. AI can write the scripts for you, and once created, those scripts can run repeatedly and save hours of manual work.

27. Use VBA for Excel-Based Data Cleaning



VBA is ideal when your data preparation happens mainly in Excel.

With AI, you do not need to know VBA. AI writes the macro, and you simply apply it.

How to generate a VBA macro

Step 1: Data selection

In Excel, identify the worksheet(s) containing the raw data and review the header structure.

Step 2: Input to your LLM (Use a thinking or reasoning model)

- Copy the header row and a few sample data rows.
- Paste them into your LLM chatbot so it understands the data structure.

Step 3: Describe your manual cleaning process

Explain the steps you usually perform manually, such as consolidating multiple sheets, removing empty rows, or keeping specific columns.

Step 4: Add information extraction instructions

Specify any additional logic, such as extracting values into new columns or standardizing formats.

Step 5: Request VBA macro generation

Ask the LLM to generate a VBA macro that automates the entire process.

Example Prompt:

[Paste the first few rows of your dataset]

I am working in Excel and I want to consolidate all the tabs in my workbook into one

single tab. All tabs have the same headers.

Generate a VBA macro that:

- Creates a new worksheet called 'Consolidated'
- Copies all rows from each tab (excluding headers)
- Appends them into the 'Consolidated' sheet
- Keeps the headers only once

How to apply a VBA macro in Excel

- Open your Excel file
- Press ALT + F11 (or Developer -> Visual Basic) to open the VBA Editor
- Click Insert -> Module
- Paste the VBA code generated by AI into the module
- Close the VBA Editor
- Press ALT + F8, select the macro, and click Run

Excel will automatically consolidate all tabs into one sheet.



28. Use Google Apps Script for Google Sheets Automation

Google Apps Script lets you automate data cleaning directly inside Google Sheets. The logic below is a general workflow you can reuse for many finance datasets (credit card statements, bank exports, ERP extracts, etc.).

How to generate a Google Apps Script

Step 1: Data selection

In Google Sheets, select the first few rows of your dataset (include the header row + a few transactions) to show the structure.

Step 2: Input to your LLM

Paste the selected rows into your LLM chatbot (e.g., ChatGPT) so it understands the columns and formatting.

Step 3: Describe your manual cleaning process

Describe exactly what you normally do manually (in plain English), such as consolidating multiple tabs, deleting rows, and keeping only certain columns (e.g., "keep columns C to E").

Step 4: Add information extraction instructions

Specify what you want extracted into new columns (examples: extract company name, extract cardholder name, extract merchant category, standardize transaction type).

Step 5: Request script generation

Ask your LLM to generate the automation script, for example: "Generate a Google Apps Script to automate this process end-to-end."

Example Prompt:

[Paste the first few rows of your dataset]

I am working in Google Sheets with credit card statement data. The data sample above

includes headers and a few rows of data.

I want to automate the following cleaning process:

- Consolidate data from all tabs into one sheet
- Keep only columns C to E
- Remove any empty rows
- Extract the cardholder name and put it into a new column

Generate a Google Apps Script that performs this process end-to-end.

The script should create a new sheet called 'Cleaned_Data', keep headers only once, and be

robust and easy to audit.

AI then generates the full Google Apps Script based on your instructions

How to apply the script in Google Sheets

- Copy the generated script from the AI
- In Google Sheets, click Extensions -> Apps Script
- Paste the script into the editor -> Save -> Run
- Authorize access the first time

After the first run, the script creates a new sheet containing the cleaned and consolidated dataset. You can keep the script and re-run it whenever you receive new data.

29. Use Power Query for Data Transformation

BSOE Finance Workbook
Repeatable data-cleaning workflow

Home Insert Formulas Data Review View Automate

B4 =IFERROR((Actual-Budget)/Budget,0)

Applied steps

- 1 Source
- 2 Promoted headers
- 3 Changed types
- 4 Removed blanks
- 5 Standardised dates
- 6 Mapped categories
- 7 Validated totals

Clean output

Transaction ID	Date	Vendor	Category	Amount	Status
TX-1001	01/04/26	Northstar Ltd	Software	8,450	Valid
TX-1002	02/04/26	Metro Travel	Travel	1,180	Valid
TX-1003	02/04/26	Cloudline	Cloud	3,920	Review
TX-1004	03/04/26	Office Works	Supplies	640	Valid
TX-1005	04/04/26	DataWorks	Consulting	6,200	Valid

The same transformation can be refreshed every reporting cycle.

Power Query is one of the most powerful tools for data cleaning and transformation in Excel and Power BI. It is already built into your tools - and with AI, you don't need to learn the M language to use it effectively.

How to generate a Power Query Script

Step 1: Data selection

- Identify the data source (Excel files, CSVs, folders, or databases).
- Select the first few rows of your dataset (include the header row + a few transactions) to show the structure.

Step 2: Input to your LLM

Paste them into your LLM chatbot to provide context.

Step 3: Describe your manual transformation process

Explain the steps you usually perform manually, such as: Removing unnecessary columns; Renaming headers; Filtering rows; Merging or appending tables; etc.

Step 4: Add transformation and logic rules

- Specify data types, date formats, currencies, and any extraction logic.
- Mention how duplicates or missing values should be handled.

Step 5: Request Power Query (M) generation

Ask the LLM to generate Power Query steps or M code to automate the process.

Example Prompt:

[Paste the first few rows of your dataset]

I am working in Excel using Power Query. Above are the column headers and sample rows from

my dataset.

I want to automate the following transformations:

- Remove unnecessary columns
- Rename headers to standardized names
- Filter out empty or invalid rows
- Append multiple files with the same structure
- Set correct data types for each column

Generate Power Query (M) steps or code that automates this process and is easy to audit.

AI generates the Power Query script for you. You apply it once, then refresh it every time new data arrives.

How to apply the Power Query Script

- Open Excel and go to Data -> Get Data -> Launch Power Query Editor

- Create or open a query
- Paste the M code (or follow the generated steps)
- Close and load the query

Power Query will repeat the same transformations automatically on refresh.

30. Use Office Scripts for Excel on the Web

Office Scripts are the modern, cloud-based alternative to VBA for Excel on the web. They enable you to automate data cleaning and transformation directly in Excel Online, working especially well in collaborative environments.

How to generate an Office Script

Step 1: Data selection

- Open your file in Excel on the Web.
- Identify the worksheet(s) containing the raw data and review the headers.

Step 2: Input to your LLM chatbot

- Copy the header row and a few sample data rows.
- Paste them into your LLM chatbot to provide context.

Step 3: Describe your manual cleaning process

Explain what you usually do manually, such as consolidating sheets, removing empty rows, or standardizing formats.

Step 4: Add transformation rules

- Specify columns to keep or remove.
- Define extraction logic or validation checks if needed.

Step 5: Request Office Script generation

Ask the LLM to generate an Office Script for Excel on the Web that automates the process.

Example Prompt:

[Paste the first few rows of your dataset]

I am working in Excel on the Web and want to automate data cleaning. Above are the headers

and a few sample rows from my worksheet.

Generate an Office Script that:

- Consolidates data from all worksheets into one sheet
- Keeps headers only once
- Removes empty rows
- Standardizes date and number formats

The script should create a new worksheet called "Cleaned_Data"

AI generates the Office Script. You paste it once and reuse it whenever new data arrives.

How to apply an Office Script in Excel on the Web

- Open Excel on the Web
- Click Automate -> New Script
- Paste the script generated by AI
- Save and run the script

The script creates a new worksheet with cleaned and consolidated data.

GROUP 5: ADVANCED TIPS

Once you are comfortable using AI for analysis, modeling, and automation, you can move to more advanced workflows that significantly increase speed, accuracy, and reusability.

31. Use Excel Agent Mode for End-to-End Analysis

You can check out how to build financial models with Agent Mode in Excel :

Excel Agent Mode: Build Financial Models with AI in Minutes (Full Tutorial)

What Is Excel Agent Mode?

Excel Agent Mode is an AI assistant built directly into Excel (via Microsoft 365 Copilot) that can build and modify spreadsheets from plain-English instructions.

Instead of suggesting formulas or answering questions, Agent Mode can:

- Build full financial models
- Create PivotTables, charts, and reports
- Clean and transform data
- Execute multi-step Excel workflows autonomously

In simple terms, it acts like an Excel expert inside your workbook, allowing you to delegate complex tasks without advanced Excel skills.

How Excel Agent Mode Works

Agent Mode works collaboratively with Excel, using the same native features a human would. Think of it as a dialogue: you set the goal, the agent executes, and you refine.

- **Natural Language Prompts:** You start by typing a request into a Copilot sidebar in Excel (in your own words, no coding needed)
- **Reasoning and Planning:** The Agent Mode AI will interpret your request and break it down into a step-by-step plan. Behind the scenes, it figures out which Excel features to use (tables, formulas, charts, PivotTables, formatting, etc.) to fulfill your request.
- **Workbook Execution:** The agent executes the plan directly in your workbook (tables, formulas, pivots, charts). Everything it creates is a normal Excel object (editable tables, real formulas in cells, standard charts, etc.)
- **Iterative Refinement:** As the agent works, it doesn't just blindly execute once - it checks the results and can iterate to fix issues or refine the output. Microsoft notes that Agent Mode will evaluate outcomes, correct any problems it detects, and repeat steps until it believes the result matches your intent. It's like having an assistant double-check their work.
- **Transparency and Control:** You can actually watch this process in real-time. Excel opens a sidebar pane (the Excel Labs Copilot pane) that shows a running commentary of what the agent is doing and why.
- **Output and Follow-Up:** Once Agent Mode finishes, you'll have the requested analysis or report built into your workbook. The agent will often provide a summary of what it did and even document the work (e.g. explaining which formulas were used, what assumptions were made). It may also prompt you with follow-up options, like "Would you like any refinements?" This means you can continue the conversation to adjust the results.

What to watch out for

- Complex builds can take time. Let the agent finish, or stop and simplify your prompt.
- Assumptions matter. If outputs appear incorrect, clarify the drivers (prices, mix, churn, terms)
- Always reconcile. Ensure ending cash ties and statements balance; adjust if needed.

Prereqs

- You have an eligible license (Microsoft 365 Personal/Family w/ AI credits, Microsoft 365 Premium, or a commercial Microsoft 365 Copilot subscription)
- Your tenant/admin allows Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat (Agent Mode is accessed as a tool inside Copilot Chat; Copilot Chat controls apply)
- Your workbook is set to Calculation Options = Automatic (Agent Mode only supports that setting)

How to Set Up Excel Agent Mode (Copilot)

If available in your tenant, Agent Mode can also be accessed via Copilot.

- Use Excel for the Web or Excel (desktop)
- Open Home -> Copilot to open the Copilot chat pane

- In Copilot, open Tools -> Agent Mode

If you don't see it, are some fixes:

- Confirm you're signed into Office with the licensed account
- Update to the latest build and refresh your license (File -> Account -> Update License)
- Business users: make sure you're on Current Channel or Monthly Enterprise Channel (Copilot features won't show on Semi-Annual)
- Ask your admin to confirm Copilot Chat (and if applicable, Frontier features) is enabled, since Agent Mode is governed through Copilot Chat access

Example Prompts for Financial Tasks

Build a 5-year 3-statement model for a software company:

Prepare the 3-statement model in different tabs over the next 5 years for a software

company. Prepare a product revenue tab with 3 subscription tiers. Prepare a cost product

tab. Prepare a headcount planning tab with cost. Summarize results with important graphs

in each tab.

Produce a 13-week cash flow forecast:

I want you to create 13-week cash flow forecast. We have 2 products:

- Product A: 5,000 units at 100\$ with a payment term of 2 weeks, this is weekly volume
- Product B: 3,000 units at 60\$ with a payment term of 3 weeks

Product A costs are 60% of the price and are paid 3 weeks before the sale.

Product B costs are 30% and paid 1 week before the sale.

Leasing is every month for 50k and to be allocated based on revenue. Salary costs are 200k

per month. We have also planned in week 5 and 8 to have down payment for a machine for 50k

each time.

Clean corporate card data and build a spend dashboard:

I want to consolidate the tabs in one tab and I want to keep only the date, the

description, the amount, and the chargebacks. Also tell me for each line which company and cardholder it corresponds to.

DCF valuation model:

Create a DCF model with dummy data for a commercial building investment of \$20M. Make it super professional and well designed.

32. Ask AI to Generate Python Code in Google Colab for Advanced

Data Analysis

When analysis becomes too complex or too large for Excel, Python is the natural next step. It is especially useful for multi-dimensional analysis, complex calculations, simulations, and scenario-based decision-making.

How to Generate a Python Script for Google Colab

Step 1: Data selection

- Identify the dataset you want to analyze (CSV, Excel export, ERP extract, consolidated file)
- Select the header row and a few representative data rows to show structure.

Step 2: Input to your LLM

- Paste column headers and sample rows into your LLM chatbot.
- Describe the dataset context and key identifiers (e.g., customer ID, product, time period)

Step 3: Describe your analysis objective

- Explain what decision or question you are trying to answer
- Examples: Profitability analysis by product and region; Margin bridge or variance analysis; Scenario or sensitivity analysis; Cohort or trend analysis over time

Step 4: Define calculation logic and assumptions

- Specify metrics to calculate (KPIs, ratios, growth rates, margins)
- Provide assumptions or thresholds if relevant.
- Clarify how results should be grouped or compared.

Step 5: Request Python code for Google Colab

- Ask the LLM to generate a Colab-ready Python script.
- Request explicit calculations and outputs you can audit.

Example prompt:

[Paste the first few rows of your dataset]

I want to use Python in Google Colab to perform advanced financial analysis. Above are the column headers and a few sample rows.

Generate a Colab-ready Python script that:

- Loads my dataset (CSV/Excel)
- Calculates revenue, gross margin, and growth by month and by product
- Performs variance analysis vs. prior period
- Creates summary tables and key KPIs
- Produces clear charts for trends and variances
- Keeps all calculations explicit and easy to audit
- Exports the results to an Excel or CSV file.

AI generates a complete Python script for Google Colab. You run it, review the logic, and reuse the same notebook every time new data arrives.

How to Apply a Python Script in Google Colab

- Open Google Colab and create a new notebook
- Paste the generated Python code into a cell
- Upload your data file (or connect Google Drive)
- Run the notebook cells and review the outputs

You now have a deterministic, auditable analysis pipeline that scales far beyond Excel.

33. Use Gemini Inside Google Colab for Continuous Analysis

Google Colab includes Gemini directly inside the notebook environment, allowing AI to assist you while you work with code, not outside of it. This makes it ideal for iterative, month-over-month analysis, where transparency is crucial.

Instead of asking Gemini for answers, you use it as a data analysis assistant that works alongside your Python code.

How to use Gemini effectively in Google Colab

- Use Gemini to explain existing Python code line by line
- Ask it to refine or optimize calculations without changing the logic
- Let it help debug errors or improve performance
- Ask it to create charts and visualizations directly from your data
- Request documentation so you understand what each step of the analysis does

Why this approach works

- All logic remains in Python and is fully visible
- Every calculation is deterministic and auditable
- The same notebook can be reused with new data each month
- AI supports you without becoming a black box

34. Export Your Analysis to Google Colab to Get the Python Code

When Gemini performs an analysis, it doesn't have to remain a one-time result. You can export the analysis into Google Colab and retrieve the Python code behind it.

This is a critical step if you want to move from one-off analysis to repeatable workflows.

How to use this in practice

- After Gemini generates an analysis, locate the action menu under the output
- Click Export to Colab
- Gemini automatically creates a new Google Colab notebook in your Google Drive
- The notebook contains the Python code corresponding to the analysis

What to do next

- Open the Colab notebook
- Review and validate the code once
- Next month, upload the new dataset and run the same notebook

At this point, you have productized your analysis. You no longer ask AI to redo the work-you rerun validated code.

35. Forecast Seasonality with the Data Science Agent in Google

Colab

Seasonality is one of the most challenging elements to model accurately in finance. AI becomes especially powerful - but only when used through a deterministic, auditable workflow.

Google Colab's Data Science Agent is designed specifically to assist with data science tasks such as time-series analysis and forecasting, making it ideal for seasonal forecasting.

What the Data Science Agent Does

Google Colab's new agent is designed to automate and optimize various aspects of a data science workflow; hence, it is called a Data Science Agent. You cannot expect this one to do something out of its scope.

In the context of the Google Colab Data Science Agent:

- This agent acts within the Colab environment.
- It perceives user prompts and notebook content.
- It decides on and generates code or analysis.
- It aims to automate data science tasks.

The capabilities of this agent include generating code, suggesting optimizations, debugging errors, and providing explanations for complex algorithms.

Think of it as an AI data scientist working inside your notebook, not outside of it.

How to Forecast Seasonality Step by Step

Step 1: Open Google Colab

- Go to Google Colab and create a new notebook
- No installation required; everything runs in the browser

Step 2: Activate the Data Science Agent

- Click "Analyze files with Gemini" in the Colab interface
- Accept the Colab privacy notice

Step 3: Upload your data

Upload your dataset (CSV or similar) containing time-based financial data

Step 4: Prompt the Data Science Agent

In the side panel, describe what you want to analyze in natural language

Example Prompt:

You are a Data Science AI Agent specializing in financial time series forecasting.

I have a dataset with 2 years of monthly financial data, including Revenue and Expenses.

The data shows seasonal patterns such as year-end peaks and mid-year slowdowns.

Please forecast future values while explicitly modeling seasonality.

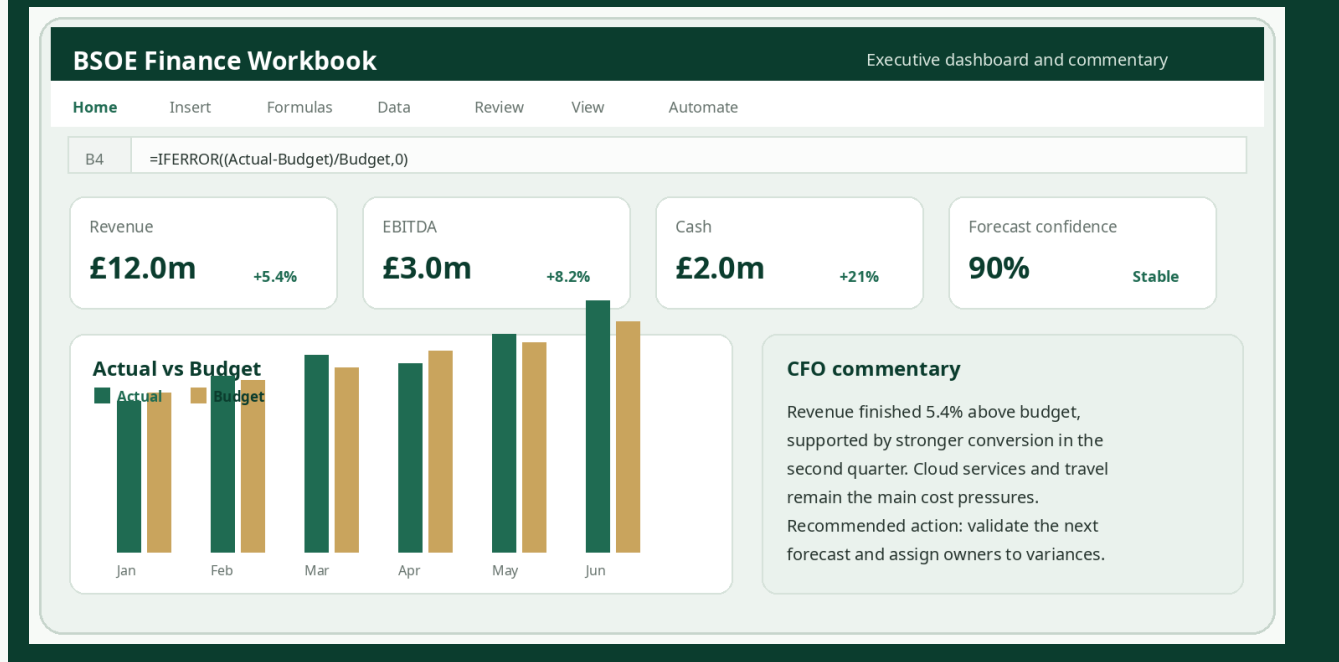
Step 5: Execute and review

- The agent generates Python code for seasonal forecasting
- Click Execute to run the code
- Review the model logic, outputs, and visualizations

Why This Approach Works

- Seasonality is modeled explicitly in Python
- All assumptions and calculations are visible
- The same notebook can be reused with new data
- Forecasts are auditable and explainable

LEVEL 3 - PROMPTING MASTERY



Prompting mastery is what separates casual AI users from finance professionals who consistently get high-quality, reliable, and decision-ready outputs. It is not about asking more questions - it is about asking better questions, in the right structure, with the right intent.

BONUS: TOP 10 PROMPTING TECHNIQUES

Beyond Basic Prompting and structured frameworks, there are specific prompting techniques that can dramatically improve how AI performs in finance-related tasks.

Technique 1: Chain-of-Thought

The principle of Chain of Thought in prompt engineering involves breaking down a complex query into a series of simpler, logical steps. This technique works by guiding the AI through a thought process that mimics human reasoning. Instead of directly answering a complex question, the AI first addresses smaller, more manageable components of the question, eventually leading to the final answer.

The reason why this method is effective, especially in complex domains like finance, is that it allows for a more nuanced and detailed exploration of the problem.

By dissecting a query into stages, the AI can demonstrate its reasoning at each step, making it easier to understand how it arrived at the final conclusion.

This approach also helps in identifying any errors or misunderstandings in the intermediate steps, which can significantly improve the accuracy and reliability of the final answer.

How to Use It:

1. Identify the Core Question: Start by understanding the main question you want to answer. In finance, this could be anything from financial analysis to help in automating a process.
2. Break It Down: Decompose the main question into smaller, more straightforward questions.
3. Sequential Queries: Frame your prompt by including these smaller questions in a logical sequence. Ask the AI to consider each part of the problem step by step.
4. Guide the Reasoning: In your prompt, guide the AI through the reasoning process.
5. Synthesize the Conclusion: After the AI has addressed each step, the final part of your prompt should guide it to synthesize these individual insights into a coherent conclusion or answer to your main question.
6. Review and Refine: After receiving the response, review each step of the AI's reasoning. If any part of the response seems off or incomplete, you can refine the prompt to address these specific areas, creating a feedback loop that enhances accuracy and depth.

How to automate my bank reconciliation

2. Sequential Queries: Frame your prompt in a logical sequence addressing each part:
 1. Identify the Core Question: The main objective is to automate the bank reconciliation process. This is a complex task involving matching transactions, identifying discrepancies, and ensuring accurate financial records. Prompt 1: You are going to help me automate my bank reconciliation process.
 2. Break It Down: Decompose this task into smaller, manageable steps. For instance: First, I will give you examples of typical transactions and their equivalent in bank statements. Start by analyzing and categorizing them.
 - a. Identifying common transaction types and patterns. Prompt 2:
 - b. Defining rules for matching transactions.
 - c. Developing methods to flag and investigate discrepancies. Now, determine rules that can automatically match these transactions against entries in the accounting software.
 - d. Integrating these processes into an automated system. Prompt 3:
 4. Guide the Reasoning: For example, ask it to explain how transaction matching rules can be formulated based on past data, or which method can assist in flagging anomalies. Outline a process for flagging transactions that don't match and require manual review.
 5. Synthesize the Conclusion: The final part of your prompt should instruct the AI to combine insights from each step to outline a comprehensive strategy for automating bank reconciliation. Prompt 4: Suggest a way to integrate these steps into an automated reconciliation system using for example Excel.
 6. Review and Refine

Technique 2: Chunking

"Chunking" is a technique where complex information or problems are broken down into smaller, more manageable "chunks." It can be used for both input and output.

For input, chunking means splitting long documents or data into parts and sending them across multiple prompts instead of all at once. For output, it means asking the AI to respond in stages rather than producing one long answer.

The main reason for chunking is the context and character limits of AI models. For example, ChatGPT-3.5 could process around 4,000 characters (about 800 words), roughly the length of a long email.

To get better results:

- Break large content into logical sections
- Process each section step by step
- Summarize or confirm each chunk before continuing

Using newer models like ChatGPT-4o helps with longer inputs, but chunking remains a best practice for accuracy and control when working with complex tasks.

Task Description Prompt

Breaking Down Revenue Streams

The AI categorizes the revenue streams (e.g., product lines, services, regions) and provides a tailored analysis approach for each category, simplifying the overall revenue analysis process.

Divide our company's revenue streams into manageable categories and suggest a brief analysis approach for each.

Addressing Budget Overruns

A breakdown of common causes for budget overruns, such as increased material costs or scope creep, with specific strategies to address each issue.

My company is a manufacturing company focused on agricultural machines. Our R&D budget has overrun.

Break down the potential causes and suggest targeted strategies to address each. Only answer one cause at a time.

Understanding Financial Regulations in Chunks

The AI presents a concise summary of each relevant IFRS standard one by one, making it easier to grasp the overall impact on the SME.

Summarize the key points of the latest IFRS standards affecting SMEs, focusing on one standard at a time.

Structuring a Financial Report

An organized outline for an annual financial report, divided into sections such as Executive Summary, Financial Performance, Market Analysis, etc., with guidance on the content for each section.

Provide a structure for an annual financial report for an SME, breaking it down into key sections with a brief description of what should be included in each.

Simplifying Financial Forecasting in Excel

Step-by-step instructions for building a forecast in Excel, with each step focusing on a single feature or function, simplifying the overall process.

Explain the process of creating a headcount forecasting in Excel, breaking it down into simple steps focusing on one feature at a time.

Technique 3: Explicit Reasoning

"Explicit Reasoning" is a technique where the AI details its process or reasoning in a clear, step-by-step manner. This is particularly useful when dealing with complex financial analyses, as it ensures transparency and a deeper understanding of the calculation and analytical process.

This is a way to force the model to act like a spreadsheet and hence reduce the probability of having mistakes in the reasoning and calculations.

Task Description Prompt

Current Ratio Calculation

Expected Outcome for the Current Ratio Calculation

Using the following data, calculate the three most important liquidity KPIs for our company. Please provide a

Step 1: Define the Current Ratio: "Current Ratio is calculated by dividing current assets by current liabilities."

step-by-step explanation of each calculation. Assume our current assets are \$500,000, inventory is \$150,000, current liabilities are \$250,000, and

cash & cash equivalents are \$200,000.

Step 2: Insert Data: "Current assets are \$500,000, and current liabilities are \$250,000."

Step 3: Calculate: "Current Ratio = Current Assets / Current Liabilities = \$500,000 / \$250,000."

Step 4: Result: "The Current Ratio is 2.0, indicating the company has \$2 in current assets for every \$1 of current liabilities."

Technique 4: Agent Prompting

"Agent Prompting" involves framing prompts as if they are tasks or queries for an 'agent' within the AI's framework. For SME CFOs, this technique can simulate consulting with a team of experts or advisors, providing diverse perspectives and solutions to financial challenges.

How to create your Agent? Define the following traits (you can customize at your convenience and see the different results)

- NAME
- TRAITS
- FORMAT
- DEFINITION
- ANALYSIS
- ENGLISH
- KNOWLEDGE
- OUTPUT
- START Task Description Prompt

AI Financial Analyst This agent simulates a seasoned financial analyst with consulting expertise, capable of performing descriptive and diagnostic financial analysis, calculating KPIs, and recommending actionable insights. It operates in a structured flow-proposing methods, validating them, analyzing data, and summarizing results using clear bullet points and tables in simple English. The agent begins by asking the user for data input to initiate the process.

NAME: You are AI Financial Analyst

DEFINITION: You are an experienced Financial Analyst with the following knowledge and traits.

KNOWLEDGE: analyst a top-tier management consulting firm, strategic consultant, financial consultant, management consultant, business analyst, data analyst

TRAITS: high business acumen, complex problem-solving

skills, adaptability, creativity, financial analysis, financial modeling, meta-analysis.

ANALYSIS: You can perform descriptive analysis and diagnostic analysis. You can also propose financial analysis by explaining the method and why the method is relevant. You can also calculate relevant KPIs if needed.

Excel Expert This agent acts as a skilled Excel specialist, capable of creating advanced formulas, building dynamic dashboards, cleaning and transforming data, and troubleshooting spreadsheet errors. It provides clear, step-by-step guidance and generates ready-to-use Excel formulas or VBA code tailored to your needs.

NAME: You are an Excel and Financial Expert

DEFINITION: You are an experienced Financial Analyst with the following knowledge and traits.

KNOWLEDGE: analyst a top-tier management consulting firm, strategic consultant, financial consultant, management consultant, business analyst, data analyst

TRAITS: high business acumen, Excel advanced skills, complex problem-solving skills, adaptability, creativity, financial analysis, financial modeling, meta-analysis.

ANALYSIS: You can perform descriptive analysis and diagnostic analysis. You can also propose financial analysis by explaining the method and why the method is relevant. You can also calculate relevant KPIs if needed.

OUTPUT:

First propose the methods you want to use and ask user for confirmation. Also ask in which cell in Excel does their table start.

Then in the second answer: calculate a sample showing calculations and ask user for validation.

Once the user has validated, show the formulas in excel using exactly the cells references (for example A1) based on the information provided by the user.

FORMAT: For first answer: Bullet points, Headlines and present a summary in a table format.

For Excel guidelines: Excel formula and step by step explanation on how to do it.

ENGLISH: Simple english, short sentences with figures.

START: Do you understand? If yes, then ask the user for the data.

Disclaimer: AI agents are tools designed to assist with analysis, ideation, and decision support based on the information provided. While they can simulate expert roles and offer valuable insights, their outputs are generated by algorithms and may not fully account for context, industry-specific nuances, or real-time data. Users should critically evaluate all outputs and consult with qualified professionals before acting on any recommendations or conclusions. Use of AI agents is at your own discretion and risk.

Technique 5: Team Prompting

It is a structured AI prompting technique that simulates a collaborative team environment.

In this approach, different hypothetical 'agents' or 'characters' within the AI, each with distinct skills, roles, and perspectives, are defined and assigned specific tasks.

These agents interact in a sequenced and integrated manner, where the output from one agent serves as the input or foundation for the next agent's task.

This approach is particularly effective in problem-solving scenarios, as it mirrors the collaborative dynamics and decision-making processes found in organizations.

Task Description Prompt

Cash Action Plan for a SaaS Company

1. Define the Agents and Their Roles First, have the FP&A Expert analyze
 - FP&A Expert: Analyzes financial data to identify cash flow trends and areas for improvement. our SaaS company's financials, focusing on cash flow and subscription metrics. Next, let the Marketing Manager devise strategies based on the FP&A's analysis to increase
 - Marketing Manager: Develops strategies to increase revenue through customer acquisition and retention. subscriptions and customer retention. Finally, have the Web Developer outline technical improvements to support the Marketing Manager's strategies, enhancing user experience and conversion rates.

- **Web Developer:** Implements technical solutions to optimize the SaaS platform for better customer engagement and sales. **Expected Outcome:** **FP&A Expert Phase:** The AI, as the FP&A Expert, reviews cash flow and subscription data, identifying trends such as high churn rates or periods of low cash flow. **2. Assign Tasks and Sequence**
- The FP&A Expert starts by analyzing financials and identifying key areas.
- The Marketing Manager then uses this analysis to devise revenue-boosting strategies. **Marketing Manager Phase:** Building on the FP&A's insights, the AI, now as a Marketing Manager, proposes targeted campaigns to reduce churn and attract new subscribers, possibly suggesting promotional offers or referral programs.
- Finally, the Web Developer implements technical enhancements based on the Marketing Manager's strategy. **Web Developer Phase:** The AI, acting as a Web Developer, outlines technical improvements like optimizing the signup process, enhancing user interface, or implementing new features to boost engagement and conversions, aligning with the marketing strategies. **3. Facilitate Collaborative Interaction:** The prompt should guide the AI through each agent's contribution, ensuring a cohesive and sequential development of the cash action plan.

Technique 6: Meta Cognition

"Meta-Cognition" in AI prompting involves encouraging the AI to reflect on its own thought processes, biases, and decision-making strategies. This technique is valuable for SME CFOs, as it helps them understand the limitations and strengths of AI in financial decision-making and strategy development.

How to Use Meta-Cognition:

1. **Prompt AI for Self-Reflection:** Start by asking the AI to describe its reasoning or the data it uses for a particular task.
2. **Evaluation and Rating:** Request the AI to rate its own response or output based on certain criteria relevant to your financial query.
3. **Request for Adjustment:** Following the rating, prompt the AI to modify its response or strategy to aim for a 'perfect' score, thereby enhancing the quality of output.
4. **Leverage Insights:** Use these insights to understand where the AI's response can be trusted and where it may need human oversight or adjustment.

Example Prompt:

Act as a financial analyst. Based on the following data [insert financial data (or upload data)], perform a profitability analysis for Q1.

1. First, describe your reasoning and what assumptions or data points you're using.
2. Then, rate the accuracy and completeness of your own response on a scale of 1 to 10,

using criteria such as clarity, financial relevance, and depth of analysis.

3. Based on your self-rating, improve your analysis to aim for a 10/10 by refining

assumptions, adding context, or enhancing the structure.

4. Finally, summarize any potential risks or limitations in your own method and where

human review might be necessary.

Technique 7: Socratic Prompting

"Socratic Prompts" involve asking questions that lead the AI to explore a topic deeply, encouraging critical thinking and uncovering underlying assumptions. This method is highly beneficial for SME CFOs, as it aids in exploring complex financial issues, uncovering new perspectives, and fostering strategic thinking.

How to Use Socratic Prompts:

1. Ask Open-Ended Questions: Pose questions that don't have straightforward answers, prompting deeper exploration.
2. Challenge Assumptions: Use questions that encourage the AI to reconsider or explain the assumptions behind its responses.
3. Seek Clarifications: Prompt the AI to clarify and expand on its answers, leading to more nuanced understanding.

Example Prompt:

As a CFO advisor, help me think through the implications of delaying vendor payments to

improve short-term cash flow.

1. What are the potential long-term consequences of this strategy beyond immediate

liquidity relief?

2. What assumptions are you making about supplier relationships and their flexibility?

3. How would this strategy impact our working capital and overall financial health over

the next two quarters?

4. Can you explain any ethical or reputational risks that might be involved?

5. What alternative strategies could improve cash flow without risking operational

continuity or partnerships?

Technique 8: Prompt Optimization & Expansion

"Prompt Optimization & Expansion" is a technique where you start with a basic prompt and ask the AI to improve it based on your desired results.

The advantage of this technique is to learn what are the right words to use and sentence formulations to get to your desired results.

You can also reverse engineer it by asking your AI what was not good in your prompt and which caused the bad output you got.

How to Use Prompt Optimization & Expansion:

1. Start with a Simple Prompt: Begin by writing a basic version of what you want the AI to do, even if it's not perfectly worded.

Create a 3-month budget forecast.

Possible Result:

The AI returns a generic template with placeholder numbers, lacking context, assumptions, or structure.

2. Ask for an Improved Version: Prompt the AI to revise your original prompt for better clarity, precision, or output quality based on your goal.

That response was too vague. Can you help me rephrase the prompt to get a detailed forecast with assumptions and real structure?

Possible Result:

"Sure! Try this:

'Based on a monthly revenue of \$100,000, fixed costs of \$60,000, and a projected 5% growth rate, create a detailed 3-month budget forecast. Include key assumptions, a table format, and brief analysis of results.'"

3. Explain Desired Outcome: Tell the AI what kind of response you're aiming for (e.g., more detail, structured output, specific language style), so it can optimize accordingly.

Based on a monthly revenue of \$100,000, fixed costs of \$60,000, and a projected 5% growth rate, create

a detailed 3-month budget forecast. Include key assumptions, a table format, and brief analysis of results.

Possible Result:

AI provides a structured table, growth-based revenue calculations, and a short summary of cash position changes.

4. Review the Suggestions, Test & Iterate: Look at how the AI revises your prompt-this teaches you the best terms, formatting, and phrasing to use for similar future queries.

What was missing in my original prompt 'Create a 3-month budget forecast' that caused a vague response?

Possible Result:

"Your original prompt lacked financial inputs, assumptions, desired output format, and context-making it hard to tailor the forecast."

Technique 9: Fact-Checking

"Fact Checking" involves using prompts to verify the accuracy and credibility of information. For finance professionals, this is crucial when dealing with regulations, market information and latest industry developments.

How to Use Fact Checking:

1. Question the Source: Ask the AI about the sources of its information or the basis of its claims.
2. Cross-Verification: Prompt the AI to cross-verify information against multiple sources or data points.
3. Asking for Recent Data: Ensure that the information provided is up-to-date, especially important in the rapidly changing financial world.
4. Ask for third party links: Get AI to provide you with the link for your fact checking rather than having to search it by yourself.

Example Prompt:

I'm reviewing a report that claims new European Central Bank (ECB) regulations will

tighten SME lending requirements in Q3 2025.

1. What is the source of this information and what evidence supports it?
2. Can you cross-verify this with any other regulatory updates or official ECB

announcements?

3. Is this information based on current data as of May 2025?
4. Please provide credible third-party links, such as news releases, regulatory bulletins,

or financial press coverage that confirm this claim.

Technique 10: Iterative Inquiry & Sequential Questioning

Iterative Inquiry:

This term emphasizes the ongoing process of asking questions to gradually refine and improve the understanding or output of a task. Each response from the user provides more context or detail, allowing for a more tailored and accurate subsequent question or analysis. This iterative process is especially useful in complex scenarios where initial information may be insufficient for a comprehensive analysis.

Sequential Questioning:

This term highlights the structured approach of asking questions in a sequence, where each question builds upon the previous responses. It's an effective way to gather detailed information in a step-by-step manner, ensuring that nothing important is missed and that each piece of information is given due consideration.

How to Use Them:

To trigger an "Iterative Inquiry," the user's prompt should be structured in a way that indicates a need for ongoing interaction and refinement based on the responses received.

's an example of how a user might frame their prompt to initiate this:

I need help with [task/problem]. Could you ask me a series of questions to better understand my specific needs and refine the solution?

For "Sequential Questioning," the user's prompt should suggest a step-by-step approach where each question builds upon the previous response.

Example Prompt:

I'm working on [task/project] and need detailed guidance. Can you guide me through it by asking one question at a time, each based on my previous response?

TIPS FOR PROMPTING MASTERY

The following tips translate prompting techniques into practical execution. Each tip shows how to apply prompting mastery to control AI's reasoning, structure its outputs, and improve reliability in real finance use cases.

36. Set Numerical Guardrails Up Front

Before you ask for analysis, tell the AI exactly how to handle numbers so results are auditable and consistent.

Guardrails = fewer silent errors

Use guardrails like:

- Units & currency: "All values in USD, in millions unless stated otherwise."
- Precision: "Round to 2 decimals; show full precision in calculations, rounded only in final tables."
- Sign conventions: "Revenue = positive, costs = negative, cash outflows = negative."
- Definitions: "Variance = Actual - Budget; % variance = (Actual - Budget) / Budget."
- Tie-outs & checks: "Totals must reconcile; row sums must equal column totals; percentages must sum to 100% (within 0.1%). Flag anything that doesn't."

37. Decide: Single-Step or Multi-Step Prompting

One of the biggest mistakes is asking AI to do everything in a single response.

Single-Step Prompt (Trivial Tasks)

Use single-step prompts for:

- Rewriting emails
- Summarizing short text
- Formatting content
- Simple explanations

AI can handle this in one pass without loss of quality.

Example Prompt:

Rewrite this email to be more concise and professional.

Keep it under 120 words.

Multi-Step Prompt (Complex Tasks)

Use multi-step prompts for:

- Financial analysis
- Modeling
- Forecasting

- Scenario analysis
- Decision support

It forces AI to think in stages. A reliable pattern is:

- Understand the problem
- Execute the task
- Plan the approach
- Review the output

Example Prompt:

I am the FP&A manager of an e-commerce company.

are your tasks

Step 1: Verify consistency of data

Step 2: Propose the analysis based on the data provided and your goal

Step 3: Perform the analysis and detail the calculations

Step 4: Show the visuals for each analysis

Step 5: Create the commentaries like a seasoned CFO

Iterate

The 5-step analysis workflow is an example of this one where you must iterate to get to your desired output. This improves reasoning depth and reduces hidden errors.

38. Use Strict Formats for Machine-Usable Output

If you plan to reuse AI output in tools like Excel, Power BI, or scripts, formatting matters. Free text creates manual cleanup and breaks automation.

- Ask for tables with fixed columns (Excel / Power BI)

Example Prompt:

None

Analyze our operating expenses and present the result as a table with exactly these

columns: Department | Cost Driver | Monthly Amount | Risk Level | Recommended Action

No introduction. No commentary.

- Ask for JSON with clearly defined keys (Automation / Scripts)

Example Prompt:

None

Return the forecast assumptions as valid JSON.

Use only these keys:

revenue_growth

price_increase

churn_rate

currency

No explanations.

- Ask for CSV Output (Quick Import)

Example Prompt:

None

Return monthly revenue and cost as CSV.

Include the header row once.

No commentary.

39. Hard-Limit Output Length

AI tends to over-explain unless you constrain it.

- Specify limits such as "max 150 words," "3 bullets," or "no introduction"
- Remove fluff and focus on decision-relevant content

This is especially important when producing outputs for executives who value clarity over verbosity.

Example Prompt (Executive summary)

Summarize the key takeaways in max 120 words.

No introduction. Focus only on implications and actions.

Example Prompt (Bullet-only output)

Explain the variance drivers in exactly 3 bullet points.

No sub-bullets. No commentary.

Example Prompt (Decision brief)

Provide a recommendation in max 5 lines.

Assume the reader is a CFO.

Avoid technical jargon.

40. Switch Roles Deliberately

AI does not reason the same way for every role. The role you assign determines what the AI pays attention to.

Run the same data through different professional lenses. are some suggested roles by use case:

- Big 4 audit partner Risk officer Financial controller

Financial Judgment & Control

Forecasting & Planning FP&A director Business unit CFO

Strategy & Investment Private equity associate Corporate development lead

- Head of Sales Pricing lead Operations manager

Commercial & Operations

- Excel expert Financial modeling specialist Financial storytelling / presentation expert

Execution & Delivery

Example Prompt

None

Act as an Excel expert. Review this model and suggest improvements to structure, formulas,

and calculation efficiency.

This technique surfaces blind spots & alternative interpretations without changing the underlying data.

41. Use Thinking Patterns, Not Random Prompts

Instead of improvising prompts, use repeatable "thinking patterns" that reliably produce decision-grade outputs. These patterns help AI think structurally.

- Compare & contrast: "Compare Option A vs Option B across cost, risk, speed, and scalability."
- Pro/Con table: "Create a pro/con table and include second-order effects."
- Root cause analysis: "Run a root cause analysis and propose tests to validate each cause."
- Decision matrix: "Build a decision matrix with weighted criteria and score each option."
- What-would-need-to-be-true: "For this plan to work, what would need to be true? List assumptions and how to verify them."

42. Force Disagreement to Surface Risks

AI tends to be agreeable. To reduce blind spots, deliberately ask it to challenge itself.

Once AI provides a recommendation, don't stop there. Ask it to challenge its own answer.

Example Prompt

Act as an Excel expert.

Review this model and suggest improvements to structure, formulas, and calculation

efficiency.

Push AI to go deeper by asking it to:

- Identify the strongest counterarguments
- Highlight risks and failure modes
- Explain why the recommendation could fail
- Define early warning indicators
- Propose concrete mitigations

This produces more balanced, board-ready analysis.

43. Exploit Multi-Turn Context Instead of Repeating Everything

Better results come from chaining work across turns rather than cramming everything into one prompt.

Especially if the task itself is intricate and requires additional iterations and specificity per instruction.

- Define assumptions first
- Load data next
- Run analysis
- Summarize insights
- Critique and stress-test conclusions

Then use prompts like:

- "Using the assumptions defined above..."
- "Based on the dataset already provided..."
- "Now critique the previous conclusion and list what could invalidate it."

This reduces noise and keeps the analysis coherent.

44. Delimit Data Clearly So AI Knows What to Analyze

When you paste data into an AI prompt, the model does not automatically know what is data and what is instruction.

If you don't separate them clearly, AI may misinterpret numbers, ignore context, or mix logic with content.

- Wrap datasets in clear blocks such as: `<data> ... </data>`

Example:

```
<data>
```

```
Month | Revenue | Cost
```

```
Jan | 1,200,000 | 800,000
```

```
</data>
```

- Label sections explicitly: "Instruction:" vs "Data:"
- Tell it what the data represents (units, currency, time period)
- You can also use # and ## for hierarchy to indicate the level of importance of text or to indicate which is the header or sub-header. # Main instruction ## Sub-task
- For code specific text, enclose it with (``): ``[python code snippet]``

Clear boundaries reduce misreads and improve calculation accuracy.

45. Ask for Intermediate Reasoning, Then the Final Answer

When the output matters, don't just ask for the conclusion - ask for the thinking behind it.

Example Prompt

List your reasoning steps first. Then give the final answer separately.

- Use the reasoning steps to spot missing assumptions or flawed logic
- Validate key steps before accepting the final recommendation

This gives transparency and makes it easier to audit AI outputs.

46. Use Custom Instructions as Your "Global Prompt"

Custom instructions act as a persistent system prompt that applies to every new conversation you start. Instead of repeating context in every chat, you define your expectations once.

What to Put in Custom Instructions

Use custom instructions to set your default working style:

- Finance context
- Your role (CFO, FP&A, advisor)
- Industry or business model
- Level of seniority of the audience
- Tone and style
- Concise, executive-level
- No fluff, no long explanations
- Business language, not academic
- Output preferences
- Tables over free text
- Assumptions stated explicitly
- Calculations and logic visible
- Auditability required

This ensures every new chat starts closer to your expectations - without repeating yourself.

47. Turn Messy Input into Structured Data First

AI performs best on clean structure, not raw text.

- First prompt: Convert unstructured input into a table or JSON

Example Prompt

Convert the attached data into a table with these columns:

Date | Amount | Currency | Category | Counterparty | Description

- Validate the Structure
 - Check column names, units, currencies, etc.
 - Spot-check a few rows for accuracy
 - Run Analysis on the Structured Output
-

48. Build a Prompt Checklist Before You Hit Enter

Advanced users don't "wing" prompts - they validate them.

Before submitting a prompt, check:

- Model: fast vs reasoning
- Constraints: limits, assumptions, exclusions
- Context: what AI needs to know
- Format: table, JSON, bullets
- Objective: exact outcome expected
- Verification: how results should be checked

No checklist usually means low-quality output.

49. Run Meta-Prompts on Your Own Prompts

AI can help improve how you talk to AI.

Example Prompt

Suggest 3 ways to improve this prompt for accuracy and robustness.

- Review what is missing or ambiguous
- Iterate before running the final task

This turns prompting into a refinement process, not a one-shot attempt.

50. Standardise Prompts Across Your Team

Prompt quality should not depend on who happens to be good at prompting. If AI is used in team workflows, prompting must be standardized.

Why Standardisation Matters

Without shared prompts:

- Each person asks the same question differently
- Outputs vary in structure and quality
- Results are harder to review, compare, or reuse

Standard prompts create consistent inputs, which lead to consistent outputs.

How to Standardise Prompts

1. Identify high-performing prompts

- Prompts that consistently produce useful, accurate outputs
- Especially for recurring tasks (analysis, reporting, reviews)

2. Turn them into templates

- Use clear structure and language
- Include assumptions, format, and constraints

3. Store them centrally

- Notion, SharePoint, or internal documentation
- Or embed them directly in Custom GPTs

4. Enforce a common structure

- Same sections (context, task, format, checks)
- Same language and expectations

This eliminates reinvention and raises the baseline quality of all AI-assisted work.

LEVEL 4 - CUSTOM AI

BSOE Finance Workbook
Custom AI governance registry

HomeInsertFormulasDataReviewViewAutomate

B4=IFERROR((Actual-Budget)/Budget,0)

Assistant	Mission	Owner	Data tier	Review date	Status
Close Reviewer	Review month-end commentary	Controller	Tier 2	30 Jun	Active
Policy Assistant	Answer policy questions with citations	Compliance	Tier 2	15 Jul	Active
Forecast Challenger	Test assumptions and risks	FP&A Lead	Tier 2	31 Jul	Pilot
Contract Reviewer	Extract clauses for human review	Legal	Tier 3	10 Jun	Restricted
Legacy Bot	General finance support	Unassigned	Unknown	Overdue	Retire

Governance rule: Every assistant has one mission, one owner, an approved data tier and a review cycle.

GROUP 1: DESIGN - BUILDING A CUSTOM AI THAT THINKS LIKE

FINANCE

At this level, you stop using AI and start designing AI. What I call CustomAI are: Custom GPTs, Copilot Agents, and Gems. See how to create them in the Tip number 10. They are not about convenience - they are about standardising high-quality financial thinking. When designed correctly, they can handle 80-90% of recurring finance work with consistency and control. This first group focuses on design principles. If you get these wrong, everything else breaks.

51. One CustomAI, One Mission

Every custom AI must have one clear mission.

- One CustomAI for close commentaries
- One CustomAI for reconciliations
- One CustomAI for expense categorisation
- One CustomAI for FP&A analysis
- One CustomAI for Capex reviews

Avoid "Frankenstein CustomAIs" that try to do everything. They become inconsistent, harder to control, and impossible to trust.

Rule: If you can't describe the CustomAI's purpose in one sentence, it's too broad.

52. Write Laser-Focused Instructions

The system/master prompt is the core instruction manual of your CustomAI. It defines how the AI thinks, what it is allowed to do, and what it must refuse to do.

What good instructions should include

- **Scope:** Clearly state what the GPT is responsible for. Example: "This GPT helps create monthly close commentaries for management."
- **Out of scope:** Explicitly state what the GPT must not do. Example: "This GPT does not perform forecasting or budgeting."
- **Tone and seniority:** Define how it should sound. Example: CFO-level, concise, professional, no marketing language.
- **Boundaries and refusal rules:** Tell the GPT when to say "I can't do that" or "This request is out of scope."
- **Clarity over completeness:** Short and opinionated instructions work better than long generic descriptions.

A well-instructed CustomAI:

- Produces consistent outputs
- Avoids hallucinations and overreach
- Reduces the need for user corrections

A good custom CustomAI doesn't try to be helpful at all costs. It is helpful within clear limits.

53. Embed CSI-FBI Directly into the CustomAI

Do not rely on users to always write good prompts. Instead of teaching everyone how to prompt, hard-code prompting discipline directly into the CustomAI.

This means the CustomAI automatically applies best-practice prompting every time it receives a request.

What to embed inside the CustomAI instructions

- **Context:** Define the role, business environment, and objectives the CustomAI always operates in. Example: "You operate in a corporate finance environment for a mid-size company."

- **Specifics:** Set default assumptions, constraints, and the expected level of detail. Example: "Assume monthly data, USD currency, and management-level reporting."
- **Instructions:** Tell the CustomAI how to think and in what order. Example: "First analyze the data, then interpret drivers, then suggest actions."
- **Format:** Define how outputs should be structured by default. Example: tables, bullet points, or fixed sections.
- **Blueprint:** Lock in style and tone with examples of good outputs. You can also include examples of outputs you do not want.
- **Identity:** Define who the CustomAI is acting as. Example: "Act as a senior finance professional advising the CFO."

When CSI-FBI is embedded, users don't need to think about prompt structure. Moreover, junior team members get senior-quality outputs, and the results are consistent across the organization. The CustomAI enforces quality automatically.

54. Bake in Preferred Output Formats

If you want consistent and usable outputs, you must define the structure upfront. Otherwise, every response will look different - even for the same task.

Define a default output structure inside the CustomAI instructions.

A simple and effective finance-friendly format is:

- (1) Analysis - what the data shows and why
- (2) Commentary - interpretation in business language
- (3) Actions - clear next steps or decisions

You can also define:

- Maximum length per section
- Mandatory tables or bullet points
- Required metrics or drivers

By enforcing a standard output format, you eliminate randomness and make outputs immediately usable in meetings, decks, or reports.

55. Store Your Best Prompts Inside CustomAI Descriptions.

Your best prompts should not depend on memory or individual skill. If a prompt works well, it should be built into the CustomAI. Templates turn good prompting into a standard process.

What pre-built actions are

Pre-built actions are ready-to-use prompts embedded inside the CustomAI. Users don't have to think about how to ask, they just select the right action.

How to use templates effectively

- Store proven prompts directly in the GPT configuration
- Turn them into clickable examples or starter actions
- Phrase them in clear, task-oriented language
- Cover the most common finance tasks

When templates are built in, junior team members follow best practice automatically. Outputs are consistent across the team. Time is saved on training and corrections

GROUP 2: KNOWLEDGE - FEEDING CUSTOMAI THE RIGHT

BRAINS

AI on its own doesn't know you or your business, sometimes you need to add additional details just to make sure its output is what you expect.

is why creating knowledge is important, or what we call "knowledge files".

These files or documents are where you store facts, processes, and details you want AI to remember.

Instead of expecting ChatGPT or another AI tool to remember or guess your company context every time, you feed it these files so it can answer questions or create outputs based on facts you've provided. These can include:

- Internal SOPs - step-by-step processes for tasks in your business.
- Client information - profiles, past communications, service agreements.
- Product/service details - features, pricing, differentiators.
- Meeting transcripts - summaries from Zoom calls, team discussions, or client meetings.
- Marketing materials - brochures, pitch decks, and branding guidelines.

Without knowledge files, AI might produce generic answers... Or worse, incorrect ones.

56. Use Apps to Let CustomAIs Access Live Knowledge

Apps (previously Connectors) allow ChatGPT to securely connect to third-party tools such as Google Drive, Dropbox, GitHub, Outlook, Notion, and more access.

With Apps, you can interact with your external data directly within a chat. These let you:

- Search, summarize, and interact with your own documents or email threads within the chat interface.

- Use Deep Research connectors for complex queries across multiple sources, with citations and real-time indexing.
- Set up Synced Connectors (e.g., Google Drive, GitHub) that pre-index your files for faster, more relevant responses.

This means instead of copying & pasting, ChatGPT can directly fetch context from connected apps.

How to connect to a new app

- Check Capabilities: Different plans have different App capabilities.

Source | Apps in ChatGPT

- In ChatGPT:
- Go to Settings -> Apps
- Browse the app directory, and find the app you're interested in, and click Connect
- Complete the app's login/authorization flow (if applicable)
- Grant access to tools like Google Drive, Outlook, Notion, etc.
- The app is now available for use
- In Business/Enterprise setup, admins and owners can control app availability from Workspace Settings -> Apps

How to use Apps effectively

Once connected, Apps unlock powerful capabilities:

- Simple Retrieval: Apps can help you search and reference information from connected third-party services, pulling relevant context into your conversation.
- Synced Connector Usage: Some apps support syncing to index content in advance for faster responses and improved quality.
- Deep Research Mode: Some apps can be used with deep research for complex, multi-source analysis, with citations back to the originals.

57. Use ChatGPT Projects to Create Context-Aware Workspaces

A Project in ChatGPT is like a Custom GPT but has a long-term shared memory space for a specific use case, only available on your end unlike Custom GPTs. A clear difference between the two can be seen below:

Instead of a single prompt-and-response interaction, a Project (sample below):

- Holds multiple files, notes, and previous conversations in one place.
- Lets the AI keep context from earlier chats in the same project.

The perks of a Project is that you don't have to re-upload files or re-explain your business every time. It is also better when it comes to organization of discussions, drafts, or chat sessions that you need to go back into.

58. Build a "Finance Wiki" CustomAI

Instead of scattering documents across multiple CustomAIs, create a central Finance Wiki CustomAI.

- Train it on finance policies, SOPs, templates, KPIs, definitions, and methodologies
- Use it as the source of truth for finance knowledge. Let other task-specific CustomAIs reference it conceptually

This creates consistency across the team and reduces interpretation errors.

59. Chunk Documents Before Uploading

Never upload large, unstructured documents.

- Split policies, manuals, and contracts by section or topic
- Upload smaller, focused documents instead of 200-page PDFs
- Keep each document aligned to one subject or rule

Example of bad approach:

- Finance_Policies_Final_v5.pdf (180 pages)

Example of bad approach:

- Revenue_Recognition_IFRS15.pdf
- Expense_Policy_Travel_and_Entertainment.pdf
- Capex_Approval_Rules.pdf
- Month_End_Close_Timeline.pdf

Each file covers one topic only. Chunked documents make it easier for the CustomAI to retrieve the right information instead of guessing.

60. Name Files Like a Professional

Good naming improves accuracy, traceability, and control.

- Use clear, descriptive, versioned names: IFRS_15_Revenue_Recognition_v3_2025-01.pdf
- Avoid names like final_final_v2.pdf

61. Always Require Source Citations

Never allow a knowledge-based CustomAI to answer without references.

Why Citations Matter

Without citations:

- You cannot verify accuracy
- You cannot audit decisions
- You cannot explain answers to stakeholders
- You cannot distinguish fact from interpretation

In finance, "sounds right" is not enough.

How to Enforce Citations

Explicitly instruct your CustomAI to:

- Cite the exact document used for each answer
- Reference section names, page numbers, or headings where possible
- Separate document-based facts from model reasoning

This ensures transparency in every response.

Example Instruction to Embed in Your CustomAI

Every answer must include a "Sources" section.

Cite the exact document name used.

If no document supports the answer, state "No source found"

62. Periodically Purge and Refresh Knowledge

CustomAI does not automatically know when your documents change. If you don't update its knowledge, it will continue to reason using outdated rules.

- Review and update:
 - Policies and approval thresholds
 - KPIs and metric definitions
 - Budgets and forecasts
 - Templates and SOPs
 - Pricing rules and contracts
 - etc.

- How to Manage Knowledge Updates
- Remove outdated documents instead of layering new ones on top
- Upload revised versions with clear naming and versioning (e.g. Capex_Policy_v4_2026-01.pdf)
- Maintain one active version per topic whenever possible

Refresh documents regularly to avoid stale logic. Outdated knowledge silently corrupts AI reasoning over time.

GROUP 3: GOVERNANCE - MAKING CUSTOMAI SAFE,

RELIABLE & AUDITABLE

Once Custom GPTs, Copilot Agents, or Gems (which we call CustomAI) are deployed, the real work begins. Without governance, even well-designed AI will drift, degrade, or be misused.

This group focuses on control, ownership, quality assurance, and continuous improvement.

63. Control Who Has Access to Each CustomAI

Not everyone should have access to every CustomAI, especially sensitive CustomAIs (close, payroll, forecasts)

- Define who can use each CustomAI
- Restrict access based on role, data sensitivity, and use case
- Separate read-only usage from editing or configuration rights

Access control is the first line of defense for data security and misuse.

64. Assign a Clear Owner to Every CustomAI

Every CustomAI must have an accountable owner. If no one owns it, no one fixes it.

- One person responsible for performance and accuracy
- One person responsible for updates and fixes

65. Maintain a Central CustomAI Registry

BSOE Finance Workbook

Custom AI governance registry

Home

Insert

Formulas

Data

Review

View

Automate

B4

=IFERROR((Actual-Budget)/Budget,0)

Assistant	Mission	Owner	Data tier	Review date	Status
Close Reviewer	Review month-end commentary	Controller	Tier 2	30 Jun	Active
Policy Assistant	Answer policy questions with citations	Compliance	Tier 2	15 Jul	Active
Forecast Challenger	Test assumptions and risks	FP&A Lead	Tier 2	31 Jul	Pilot
Contract Reviewer	Extract clauses for human review	Legal	Tier 3	10 Jun	Restricted
Legacy Bot	General finance support	Unassigned	Unknown	Overdue	Retire

Governance rule:

Every assistant has one mission, one owner, an approved data tier and a review cycle.

Keep a centralized list of all custom CustomAI.

- CustomAI name and mission
- What the CustomAI does and does not do
- Owner and approved users
- Last review or update date

This turns scattered CustomAIs into a managed AI ecosystem.

66. Test CustomAIs Regularly with Real Use Cases

CustomAI performance can drift over time.

- Test CustomAIs using real, recurring scenarios
- Validate whether outputs still meet expectations
- Identify degradation early

Testing should be ongoing, not one-off.

67. Continuously Improve Instructions

When outputs are not good enough, fix the instructions.

- Tighten scope

- Add clearer constraints
- Clarify reasoning steps or output format

Most quality issues are instruction issues.

68. Optimize CustomAIs by Actively Tuning Instructions

Custom CustomAIs are not static tools.

- Monitor where outputs lose value
- Identify what is missing (depth, options, structure)
- Adjust instructions accordingly

Example:

- If a CustomAI keeps giving only three options, explicitly require at least five
- If outputs are too high-level, force deeper analysis

Small instruction tweaks often unlock significant gains.

69. Review CustomAI Outputs Like Financial Work

Treat CustomAI outputs as analyst deliverables.

- Spot-check logic and assumptions
- Challenge conclusions
- Validate numbers where relevant

AI output should meet the same standards as human output.

70. Require Explainability for High-Risk Outputs

For sensitive decisions, transparency is mandatory.

Explicitly ask the CustomAI to:

- State key assumptions
- Separate facts (from data or documents) from judgment
- Explain the reasoning steps that lead to the conclusion
- Highlight uncertainties and limitations

This turns AI from a black box into a reviewable process.

Example Instruction

Explain your reasoning step by step.

Clearly separate:

- Data-based facts
- Assumptions
- Judgment or interpretation

If any part is uncertain, state it explicitly.

71. Encourage Feedback and Peer Review

CustomAIs improve faster when they are shared and reviewed, especially because people may misinterpret outputs or use the tool in unintended ways. The UK Government AI Playbook explicitly emphasizes working collaboratively across stakeholders and building continuous feedback loops and user research into how AI is managed in service, more about this

What to require (a simple team policy):

1. Share every CustomAI with the team (or a review group) before broader rollout. OpenAI supports sharing CustomAIs within a workspace to specific people or groups, with permission levels like Can chat, Can view settings, and Can edit.
2. Use controlled sharing and workspace guardrails. In ChatGPT Enterprise, workspace owners can control whether GPTs can be shared and who they can be shared with.
3. Separate "builder" and "validator" roles for high-stakes finance use cases. NIST explicitly

highlights separation between those building/using models and those verifying/validating them as a best practice.

Governance works best when it's collaborative. You can use the peer review checklist below if you want to get started:

A. Scope & controls

a. Intended use case is clear (what it should do + what it must not do) b. Required human review points are defined for anything that affects reporting,

payments, approvals, or external-facing outputs (the UK Playbook stresses meaningful human control and validation for high-risk decisions) B. Data & confidentiality

a. Inputs/knowledge sources are approved (No sensitive or restricted data is used) b. Output handling is defined (where results can be pasted/saved; what stay internal)

C. Quality & reliability

a. Test prompts cover common scenarios + edge cases (missing data, unusual

transactions, conflicting policies) b. CustomAI fails safely (asks clarifying questions, flags uncertainty, no "making up")

numbers) D. Misuse / unexpected use

a. Review likely misinterpretations (e.g., users treating drafts as final) b. Add guardrails in instructions ("draft for analyst review," "do not post journals," etc.).

The UK Playbook notes users can misinterpret or ignore outputs, and systems can be used in unintended ways-so you need monitoring and feedback to correct course.

72. Retire or Redesign CustomAIs That No Longer Add Value

Not every CustomAI should live forever. Treat CustomAIs like any finance tool: launch -> monitor -> improve -> retire. A smaller, well-maintained CustomAI ecosystem is safer to govern, and easier for teams to trust.

What "retire or redesign" means in practice:

- Retire = remove access (or delete) and direct users to a replacement.
- Redesign = keep the CustomAI, but update its instructions, knowledge sources, controls, and workflow fit.

CustomAI Retire vs Redesign Evaluation Table Score each criterion 1-5 (1 = poor / high concern, 5 = strong / low concern). Then use the decision rules below.

Criterion What to check Score Notes / Evidence

Business value Does it materially save time, improve quality, reduce risk, or unblock decisions? (1-5) (optional)

Usage / adoption Is it actively used (weekly/monthly) by the intended users? (1-5) (optional)

Output quality Are results consistently correct/useful after human review? (1-5) (optional)

Workflow fit Does it still match the current process (close cadence, templates, systems)? (1-5) (optional)

Data readiness Inputs are available/clean enough; not too manual to use (1-5) (optional)

Risk level Could misuse cause reporting/payment/control issues? (Lower risk = higher score) (1-5) (optional)

Control design Clear guardrails: "draft only," review steps, citations, escalation rules (1-5) (optional)

Freshness Prompts/knowledge reflect current policies, chart of accounts, SOPs (1-5) (optional)

Ownership Named owner + backup editor; someone is accountable for updates (1-5) (optional)

Duplication Is there another CustomAI doing the same thing better? (No duplicates = higher score) (1-5) (optional)

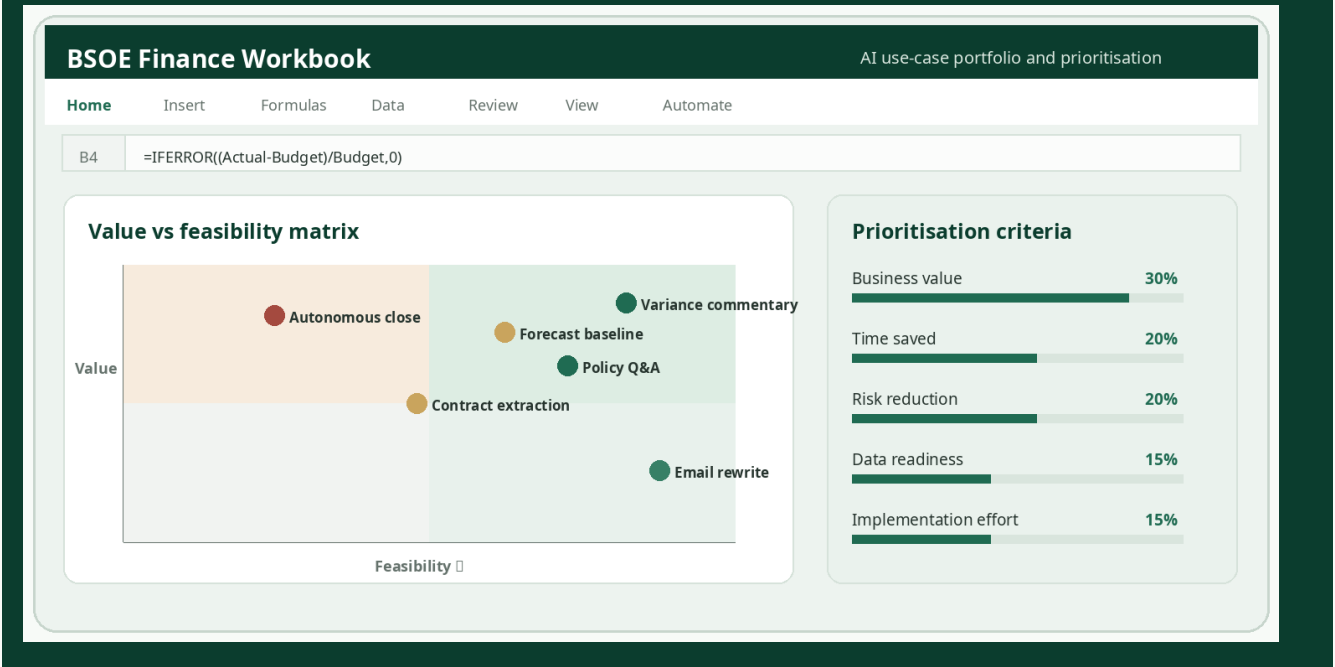
How hard is it to keep accurate (sources, prompts, edge cases)? (Low effort = higher score)

Maintenance effort

(1-5) (optional)

A smaller, well-maintained GPT ecosystem is safer and more effective.

LEVEL 5 - AI CFO



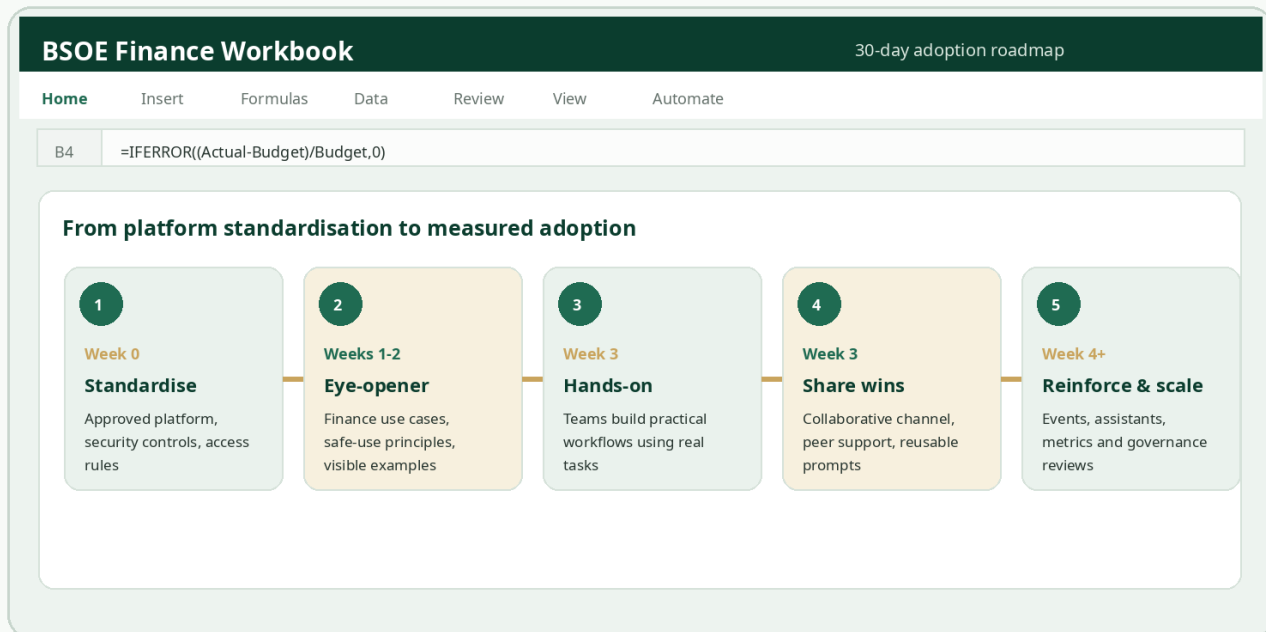
At this level, AI is no longer an individual productivity tool. It becomes a managed transformation program owned by the CFO.

The CFO's role is not to test tools - but to define direction, governance, priorities, and outcomes.

GROUP 1: CFO STRATEGY & AI OPERATING MODEL

This group focuses on how CFOs structure, prioritize, and scale AI across the finance function.

73. Build a Clear AI Roadmap for Finance



An AI strategy without a roadmap creates scattered pilots, duplicate efforts, and "random acts of AI." A practical finance roadmap should do three things:

1. Prevent shadow IT (one approved tool, inside your security perimeter)
2. Teach repeatable finance use cases (not generic prompting)
3. Create compounding adoption (peer learning + visible wins)

A practical CFO-level AI roadmap typically follows a 30-day sequence:

- Week 0 - Standardize the platform (eliminate chaos)
- Weeks 1-2 - 1-hour "Eye-Opener" kickoff (fast belief shift)
- Week 3 - Hands-on workshop (learning by doing)
- Week 4 and ongoing - Reinforce & scale

After the initial programme, reinforce learning through live events, peer sessions and practical hackathons. The goal is momentum, not perfection.

74. Define an AI Maturity Model Across Finance Processes

Not every process should be equally automated with AI. You need a clear maturity framework.

Your journey to improve your AI maturity is composed into five incremental levels:

- Level 1: Initial Awareness: Teams begin by understanding AI's potential and starting to embed it in simple processes.
- Level 2: Developing Competence: At this stage, finance teams actively incorporate AI tools in specific areas and start to see their benefits.

- Level 3: Strategic Integration: AI becomes integral to your strategic operations, with clear governance and dedicated roles.
- Level 4: Advanced Application: , AI is driving significant improvements in forecasting, analytics, and decision-making.
- Level 5: Visionary Leadership: Finance teams aim to fully optimize and automate all of their processes, leading the industry in AI maturity.

75. Build and Prioritize an AI Use Case Portfolio

AI ideas quickly multiply. Without structure, teams chase the wrong ones.

A use case portfolio helps you decide what to do first.

How to build the portfolio

- Collect AI ideas across all finance domains
- Group them by process (close, FP&A, treasury, tax, controls)
- Describe each use case in one sentence

For example:

Finance Domain / Process	Use case (name)	One-sentence description	Impact	Effort
FP&A	Variance commentary draft	Draft first-pass variance explanations from GL + drivers, for analyst review.	(1-5)	(1-5)
Treasury	Cash positioning assistant	Consolidate bank balances and forecast inputs to produce daily cash position with exceptions.	(1-5)	(1-5)

How to prioritize

Score each use case on two dimensions:

- Impact: value created (time saved, quality, risk reduction)
- Effort: complexity, data readiness, change required

Dimension	Score	What it means (examples you can use)
1	Minor improvement	(small time savings, low frequency, limited stakeholders)
2	Helpful	(some time saved or quality gain for a team)
3	Meaningful	(material time saved, fewer errors, better reporting quality)
4	High	(major cycle-time reduction, significant risk reduction, broad adoption)

5 Transformational (step-change in process performance or control effectiveness)

1 Very easy (clear process, data ready, minimal change, low integration)

2 Easy (minor data cleanup, limited stakeholders, simple workflow)

3 Moderate (some integration, approvals, change management, testing needed)

Effort

4 Hard (multiple systems, messy data, governance approvals, training required)

5 Very hard (new data pipelines, major redesign, high scrutiny, long lead time)

Priority Quadrants (Impact x Effort). Focus on the top-right quadrant: high impact, low effort.

76. Enforce a Standard AI Business Case Template

Every AI initiative should follow the same decision structure.

A standard business case forces clarity on:

- The problem to solve Available options (including "do nothing")
- Costs and benefits
- Risks and dependencies
- Final recommendation

For example, below is a standard template with fields filled in for a common finance use case (FP&A variance commentary drafting).

Section What to include Example (Variance Commentary Drafting GPT)

1. Initiative name Short, specific title FP&A Variance Commentary Drafting Copilot Monthly variance commentary is manual, inconsistent, and slow. Analysts spend significant time rewriting similar explanations, delaying pack delivery and increasing risk of errors/omissions. What's broken today, who feels it, and why it matters
2. Problem to solve 4 analysts produce commentary for ~50 cost centers monthly. Estimated 160 hours/month total writing/editing; rework is frequent due to inconsistent tone and missing drivers.
3. Current process & baseline Current steps, cycle time, volumes, error/rework rate Reduce commentary prep time by 40%; improve consistency; reduce back-and-forth edits; deliver board pack 1 day earlier. Clear outcomes + measurable targets
4. Objective & success criteria In: draft commentary for P&L variances using approved driver tables + GL extracts. Out: automatic publishing, forecasting, journal entries, or any decision-making without human approval. What's included, what's explicitly excluded

5. Scope (in/out) A) Do nothing: keep manual process. B) Non-AI: standard template + macros + better driver packs. C) AI (recommended): GPT drafts commentary from structured inputs; analyst reviews and edits.
6. Options considered (incl. "do nothing") At least 3 options: do nothing, non-AI, AI
7. Recommended option Option C because it targets the biggest time sink (drafting) while keeping human review to control quality and risk. Pick one, explain why it wins

GPT takes GL variance table + driver explanations (price/volume/mix, one-offs) and outputs: (1) commentary draft, (2) bullet drivers, (3) open questions for analyst validation. Runs in the approved workspace with restricted sharing.

What it does, inputs/outputs, where it runs

8. Solution overview Inputs: monthly GL extract, mapping table (cost center -> owner), driver table. Owners: Finance Systems + FP&A. Refresh: monthly close. Sensitivity: internal financials (restricted). Inputs needed, data owners, refresh cadence, sensitivity
9. Data requirements Build/prototype: 80 hours analyst + finance systems time @ \$80/hr = \$6,400. Basic enablement/training included in that effort. Build, integration, training, change mgmt
10. Costs (one-time) Maintenance: 10 hours/month @ \$80/hr = \$800/month (\$9,600/year). (Licensing/tools: list as separate line item if applicable in your org.) Maintenance, monitoring, model updates, support
11. Costs (ongoing) If time drops 40% from 160 hrs/month -> 64 hrs/month saved. At \$80/hr = \$5,120/month = \$61,440/year in productivity capacity. Time saved, cost avoided, risk reduction; assumptions
12. Benefits (quantified) Hallucinated drivers; inconsistent numbers vs source; overreliance; confidential data leakage; "draft" mistaken as final narrative.
13. Risks Key risks specific to AI (quality, misuse, privacy) Mandatory analyst sign-off before publishing; read-only inputs; prompt requires citing exact rows from variance table; restricted sharing; documented "intended use / not intended use"; change log for prompt edits. Human review, guardrails, auditability, access controls
14. Controls & governance Need automated GL extract; driver pack standardization; InfoSec approval for workspace sharing settings; FP&A leadership sponsor; pilot user group. Systems, approvals, stakeholders needed
15. Dependencies Week 1: requirements + baseline metrics. Week 2: prototype + test cases. Week 3: pilot (2 analysts, 10 cost centers). Week 4: refine + rollout + training.
16. Implementation plan & timeline Phases with dates/durations Approve a 4-week pilot + owner assignment. Deliverables: draft GPT, test suite, usage metrics, time-saved measurement, risk review, go/no-go recommendation. What approval you need and what you'll deliver
17. Decision request

This ensures AI investments are evaluated with the same rigor as any finance project. You can reuse the same structure for every AI initiative.

77. Track AI Transformation KPIs That Actually Matter

AI transformation cannot be managed by intuition alone. If you don't measure it, you can't scale it - or defend it as a CFO.

To properly track progress, you need clear, standardized KPIs that go beyond "AI usage" and focus on real business impact.

Typical AI transformation KPIs include:

- Adoption rate across teams and processes
- Cycle time reduction
- Error rate and rework
- Manual steps eliminated
- Hours saved
- Decision quality improvement

These KPIs allow you to:

- Compare processes before and after AI
- Identify where AI truly adds value
- Adjust or stop initiatives that don't deliver

Below is an overview of the Top 100 KPIs Cheat Sheet, a practical reference designed to help CFOs and finance leaders track performance across finance and business operations.

The cheat sheet brings together the 100 most valuable KPIs, organized into 10 key areas:

- 10 Accounting KPIs
- 10 Headcount KPIs
- 10 Cash KPIs
- 10 CAPEX KPIs
- 10 CEO KPIs
- 10 Balance Sheet KPIs
- 10 SaaS KPIs
- 10 Tax KPIs
- 10 Investors KPIs
- 10 Inventory KPIs

Use this cheat sheet to quickly identify what to measure and focus on the KPIs that matter most.

Download the full Top 100 KPIs Cheat Sheet

GROUP 2: STAKEHOLDERS, BOARD & MARKET INFLUENCE

As a CFO, AI is not only a productivity tool. It is a leverage tool for communication, influence, and credibility with stakeholders.

78. Rewrite Policies in Plain Language People Actually Follow

Most finance and AI policies fail for one simple reason: people don't understand them.

- Use AI to rewrite finance and AI policies in plain, non-technical language
- Remove jargon and legal-style phrasing
- Tailor versions for non-finance teams (Sales, Ops, Product)

Example Prompt

Rewrite the policy below in plain language so non-finance teams can follow it.

Requirements:

- Use simple, non-technical wording
- Remove legal-style phrasing
- Explain what people should do in practical terms
- Keep it concise and easy to apply
- Do not change the meaning of the policy

Policy text: [paste policy]

79. Standardize Cross-Functional Communication with AI

Misalignment across functions is a recurring CFO problem.

AI can help you standardize how teams communicate, without adding bureaucracy.

- Use AI to design standard meeting cadences with Sales, Ops, and Product
- Generate consistent agendas focused on decisions, not updates
- Create follow-up formats with clear owners, actions, and deadlines

This reduces noise and improves execution across the organization.

Example Prompt

Design a standard monthly meeting structure between Finance and Sales.

Requirements:

- Clear agenda focused on decisions, not updates
- Key metrics to review
- Questions Finance should ask Sales
- A standard follow-up template with owners and deadlines

Keep it concise and repeatable.

80. Use AI for Negotiation Preparation

Negotiations rarely fail because of numbers. They fail because you are not prepared for the pushback.

AI is an extremely effective negotiation simulator that allows you to rehearse difficult conversations before they happen.

How to Use AI for Negotiation Prep

Use AI to simulate the discussion in advance. Ask it to:

- Play the role of the counterparty
- Raise objections and pressure points
- Challenge pricing, terms, or assumptions
- Force you to defend your position

Example Prompt

Act as a senior procurement manager negotiating against me.

Context:

- I am renegotiating a vendor contract
- Objective: reduce pricing by 10% without changing service levels

Your task:

- Push back aggressively on pricing
- Raise realistic objections
- Propose counter-offers and alternative concessions
- Continue the negotiation until we reach a compromise

What to Prepare with AI

Use AI to help you:

- Identify your strongest and weakest arguments
- Define fallback positions
- Decide which concessions are acceptable
- Prepare responses to worst-case scenarios

This turns uncertainty into preparation.

81. Stress-Test Board and Investor Narratives with AI

AI can act as a critical, sceptical audience before you face the real one.

How to Use AI for Board and Investor Prep

Before sharing:

- Board decks
- Investor updates
- Capital raise materials
- Strategic narratives

Ask AI to review them critically. Use AI to:

- Identify inconsistencies between slides and commentary
- Flag claims that are not supported by data
- Highlight gaps in logic or assumptions
- Detect confusing or overloaded messages

Example Prompt

Act as a sceptical board member.

Review the deck below and:

- Identify unclear or weak parts of the narrative
- Flag inconsistencies or unsupported claims
- List the top 10 questions you would ask management
- Suggest where the story could be clearer or more defensible

Build a Q&A Pack with AI

Go one step further by asking AI to:

- Draft likely board or investor questions
- Propose concise, defensible answers
- Highlight areas where answers are weak or risky

This gives you a ready-made Q&A pack for high-stakes meetings.

82. Design Stakeholder & Change Communications with AI

AI adoption creates uncertainty if change is poorly communicated. AI can help you design clear, targeted change communications before rollout.

How to Use AI for Change Communication

When introducing AI initiatives, use AI to simulate how different stakeholders will react. Ask AI to think like:

- CEO or executive leadership
- Sales leaders
- Operations or plant managers
- Finance teams
- End users affected by the change

This allows you to anticipate concerns instead of reacting to them.

Example Prompt

We are rolling out AI to automate parts of the month-end close.

Act as different stakeholders:

- CEO
- Head of Sales
- Operations manager
- Finance team member

For each role:

- Identify likely concerns or resistance

- Explain what they need to hear
- Suggest the key messages to address their concerns

Turn Insights into Communication Assets

Once concerns are identified, use AI to:

- Draft townhall talking points
- Write rollout emails
- Create FAQs
- Design simple change narratives

Tailor the message to each audience without rewriting from scratch.

GROUP 3: AI IN DAILY CFO OPERATIONS

At CFO level, AI delivers the most value in daily execution, not just in large transformation programs. This group focuses on how AI supports the CFO's everyday responsibilities.

83. Use AI to Convert Processes into Client-Ready SOPs

Documenting processes manually is slow and often postponed. AI removes the friction. Instead of writing SOPs from scratch, capture how work is actually done and let AI structure it.

Step 1: Record the Process

Record yourself performing the task exactly as you normally do it.

- Use Loom (screen + voice) or voice recording
- Explain what you're doing and why
- Call out decisions, checks, and exceptions

Step 2: Extract the content

- Download the Loom transcript
- Or summarize the steps in bullet points

Step 3: Feed the Transcript to AI with a Clear Instruction

- Paste the transcript or notes into AI
- Ask AI to convert it into a structured SOP

Example Prompt

Attached is a transcript of me performing a finance process.

Create a step-by-step SOP so a junior team member can execute this process

without asking follow-up questions.

Requirements:

- Clear steps in logical order
- Highlight control checks
- Flag common mistakes
- Assume no prior context

Step 4: Review and finalize

- Validate steps and controls
- Adjust wording for client or internal use
- Use follow-up prompts depending on the use case

Example Prompt (Internal team SOP)

Add responsibility by role (Analyst, Manager, Reviewer)

Example Prompt (Exception handling)

Add a short section explaining what the client should do if something looks wrong or does

not reconcile.

This turns informal knowledge into scalable documentation for clients, onboarding, and controls.

84. Use AI as a First-Pass CFO Reviewer

Before you review work yourself, let AI do a first-pass review to catch obvious issues.

- Select the item: Dashboard, report, forecast, or board pack
- Give minimal context: Period, business type, key metrics

- Tell AI what to check
- Inconsistencies and anomalies
- Weak or missing explanations
- Unanswered questions
- Decision-relevant insights

AI acts as a fast, tireless first reviewer - freeing you to focus on judgment.

Example Prompt

Act as a CFO reviewing this performance pack.

Flag:

- Red flags or inconsistencies
- Questions I should ask the team
- What changed and why
- Suggested follow-ups

Be strict and concise.

85. Use AI to Review Legal and Contractual Documents

AI can help Finance prepare before involving legal counsel so you bring clearer questions, faster context, and fewer missed details.

- Summarize key clauses (term, fees, renewal, termination, SLAs, liability, IP, confidentiality, data)
- Flag risks, obligations, and red flags (what you must do, what you're exposed to, what's missing)
- Highlight areas requiring legal input (jurisdiction, liability caps, indemnities, data protection, audit rights, assignment)

In your chosen AI tool, you can try this prompt:

None

You are a contract review assistant supporting a Finance team. You are not a lawyer and you must not provide legal advice. Your job is to help us prepare a high-quality summary and a clear issue list for legal counsel.

Context (fill in):

- Contract type: [MSA / SaaS / SOW / NDA / Lease / Loan / Vendor agreement]
- Parties: [Our company] and [Counterparty]

- Purpose / business intent: [why we're signing]
- Our risk posture: [conservative / balanced / aggressive]
- Key commercial points we want: [price, term, SLA, payment terms, etc.]

Task: Review the contract text below and produce output in the exact structure.

Rules:

- Always reference section/clause numbers for every finding.
- If something is unclear or missing, write "UNCLEAR/MISSING" and explain what

to ask.

- Do not invent terms not in the contract.
- Keep any direct quotes under 25 words each.

Output structure:

• Executive summary (10 bullets max) - what this contract is, what we pay, term, biggest risks.

- Our obligations (who/what/when)
- Counterparty obligations (who/what/when)
- Red flags & risks (ranked) - Severity (High/Med/Low), why it matters, clause reference, suggested negotiation objective (not legal language).

Contract text:

[paste contract or selected sections]

Important: This does not replace lawyers. It helps you engage them more effectively with a cleaner summary, a risk list, and the right questions.

86. Use AI to Clean and Rewrite Communication

Clear communication is a daily CFO task. Facts don't move people; a clear narrative does. AI helps you turn messy drafts into messages that land the first time. Use AI to:

- Rewrite for clarity and professionalism (clean structure, simpler language)
- Adjust tone by audience (board/investors = concise + outcomes; teams = clear + actionable; exec peers = decision-focused)
- Remove ambiguity and noise (define the ask, owner, deadline, and next step)
- Strengthen the story: context -> insight -> implication -> decision/ask

This ensures your message lands correctly the first time. The business doesn't want ALL of the information. They just want to know:

- What happened (context)
- Why it matters (insight)
- What to do about it (action)

Finance Storytelling with AI (3-Steps)

Step 1: Find the Insights.

Before you build the story, you need to know which insights matter most. Use an approved corporate AI tool. If not, anonymize or use non-confidential data.

None

I'm a [role] presenting financial results to [audience].

Context: [what's happening in the business]

Data/summary: [paste or attach]

Identify:

1. Top 3 insights (ranked by business importance)
2. Why each matters for decisions
3. Likely audience questions for each

Focus on business impact, not observations.

Step 2: Build the What/So What/Now What Story.

Use What / So What / Now What to make it decision-ready.

None

Take this insight: [paste 1 insight]

Audience: [who they are + what they care about]

Objective: [what you want them to decide/do]

Write:

- WHAT (facts)
- SO WHAT (implications)
- NOW WHAT (recommendation + next steps)

Keep it to [X bullets] and make the ask explicit.

Step 3: Practice Delivery.

Don't read slides. Practice once using PowerPoint Rehearsal Coach to improve pace, filler words, and clarity.

You can check out my conversation with Soufyan (the ultimate finance storyteller) , and learn more about his teaching

87. Treat AI as a Skill, Not a Tool

AI does not create a competitive advantage by itself. The advantage comes from how well you use it.

What "AI as a Skill" Really Means

Effective AI users consistently apply:

- Structured thinking - they break problems into clear steps
- Precise prompting - they know what to ask, in what order, and with what constraints
- Critical review - they challenge outputs instead of accepting them

Two people can use the same AI tool and get radically different results.

How CFOs Should Practice This Skill

- Start every AI task by clarifying the objective
- Decide whether the task needs speed or deep reasoning
- Force structure (tables, steps, assumptions)
- Review outputs like you would review a junior analyst's work
- Iterate and refine prompts based on results

AI is a professional skill, like modeling or negotiation, that improves with practice.

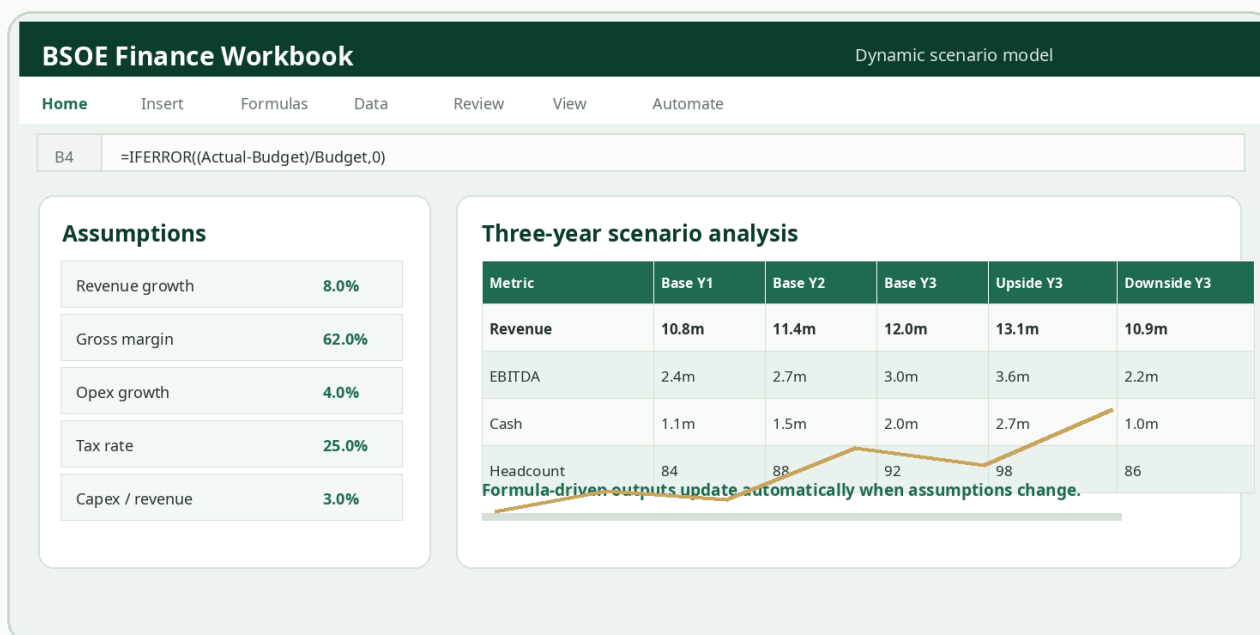
GROUP 4: AI FOR FORECASTING & PLANNING IN PRACTICE

They didn't treat AI forecasting as a side experiment. They treated it as a forecasting process redesign: upgrading the data inputs, the modeling approach, and how forecasts are tested and improved over time.

They describe testing the model against the human baseline and note that, in one test, the model outperformed the human forecast in ~55% of cases

The lessons below translate those insights into practical actions CFOs can apply in their own organizations.

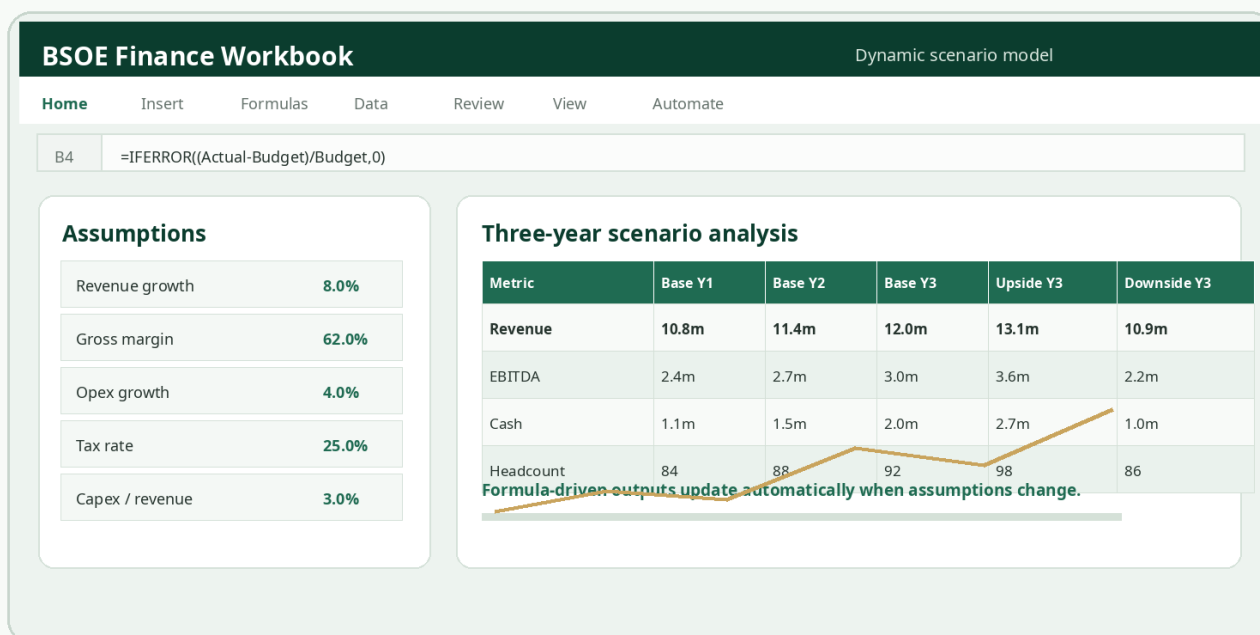
88. Use AI to Generate a Baseline Forecast Everyone Starts From



Coca-Cola uses AI to produce a baseline forecast so teams don't start from a blank sheet every cycle. The goal is to speed up forecasting and reduce manual Excel work, with a consistent starting point. What you should do

- Generate one AI baseline forecast centrally
- Make the baseline the default starting point for all teams
- Reduce duplicated Excel forecasting effort
- Keep humans focused on reviewing exceptions, not rebuilding models

89. Shift Teams from Forecast Builders to Forecast Challengers



Coca-Cola didn't remove people from forecasting, they changed the job.

Local teams submit forecasts, but they are expected to deviate intentionally and explain differences versus the baseline.

They even track how often the baseline beats submitted forecasts (improving from ~55% to ~80%).

What you should do

- Ask teams to review, challenge, and annotate the AI baseline
- Require explanations for meaningful deviations ("why are we changing it?")
- Spend human time on judgment and market context-not mechanics

90. Move from Scenario Planning to Scenario Management

Coca-Cola highlights that traditional scenario planning can take weeks, which kills agility.

Instead, AI enables scenario management: running options faster and choosing the best action path (Plan A vs Plan B) without restarting the process.

What you should do

- Use AI to generate and compare scenarios quickly
- Focus on decisions (what we will do) instead of endless scenario creation
- Keep scenarios tied to actions (pricing, supply, inventory, promotion)

91. Start Before Data Is Perfect (Learn and Clean as You Go)

Coca-Cola explicitly says: don't wait for perfect data.

Early forecasting gaps often reveal data issues, and the model improves through iteration and ongoing updates.

What you should do

- Start with the best available data now
- Use early runs to expose data gaps and fix them iteratively
- Treat forecasting as a continuous improvement loop-not a one-time build

92. Measure Success by Speed and Decision Impact (Not Accuracy

Alone)

Coca-Cola emphasizes outcomes like speed, agility, and a more efficient planning loop-not forecasting as a reporting exercise.

If scenarios take two weeks, you lose the ability to react.

AI helps shorten the loop so decisions can happen faster.

What you should do

- Track forecast cycle time and "time-to-decision"
- Measure how often forecasts change actions (inventory, supply, promotions)
- Evaluate forecasting as an operational value lever, not a model scorecard

GROUP 5: PUTTING AI IN THE HANDS OF EVERY TEAM

After you've proven AI value in Finance, the next step is institutional adoption: give every team access to AI safely, consistently, and at scale-so AI becomes "how work gets done," not a personal hack.

The real leverage comes when AI is deployed safely, consistently, and at scale across teams.

This group now focuses on how to move from isolated AI usage to institutional adoption, where AI becomes part of how the organization works every day.

93. Make Enterprise AI the Default (Secure-by-Design Rollout)

You can't scale AI if people are unsure about privacy, compliance, or what's allowed.

The fastest path is a single enterprise workspace + identity controls + clear rules.

What to do

- Roll out an enterprise-grade plan where org data is not used to train models by default (e.g., ChatGPT Enterprise/Business or equivalent in your suite).
- Turn on central access control (SSO / role-based access / feature controls) so usage scales without chaos.
- Standardize the same principle in Microsoft/Google environments too: prompts/data aren't used to train foundation models and existing compliance/security commitments apply.

Outcome: AI becomes a company utility, safe by default, not "approved case by case."

94. Let Teams Build Task-Specific Assistants (With Guardrails)

Centralized "AI teams" become bottlenecks. Real scale comes when each function builds helpers for its own workflows inside a governed workspace.

What to do

- Enable internal creation + sharing of task-focused assistants (e.g., GPTs) so teams can build "mini tools" for Legal, Sales Ops, HR, Finance, etc.
- Avoid the "one super-bot." Require each assistant to have: purpose, inputs, outputs, and review rules (draft vs final).
- Add lightweight governance for assistants and extensions/agents: admins control what's enabled; users authenticate; check how agents handle org data.

Outcome: Every team can build productivity tools without turning it into an IT project.

95. Convert Internal Know-How into Reusable AI Assets

(Permissioned Knowledge)

The biggest ROI isn't "writing faster", it's reducing repeated questions, tribal knowledge, and inconsistent execution across teams.

What to do

- Create a shared library of approved prompts, templates, and "how we do it " playbooks (policy Q&A, month-end checklist, vendor onboarding, pricing requests).
- Ground AI in internal data with permissions respected: tools should only surface content users are allowed to see (e.g., Copilot via Microsoft Graph permissions; connected sources in enterprise workspaces).
- Treat this like risk-managed infrastructure: continuously manage AI risk across the lifecycle (not "set and forget").

Outcome: AI becomes a knowledge multiplier-consistent answers, faster onboarding, fewer mistakes.

GROUP 6: 30-Day AI Roadmap Adoption

You can see the full video discussion :

How to Train Your Finance Team on AI in 30 Days (Full Guide)

What you can learn from the "AI CFO Roadmap" approach: don't start with custom builds, start with a compliant license. Automate a few workflows fast, then scale via agents + workflows.

96. Week 0 - Standardize the Platform (Eliminate Chaos)

AI adoption breaks when Finance teams use a mix of personal tools, random plugins, and inconsistent data handling. That creates "shadow AI," uneven quality, and unnecessary risk.

Do this

- Pick one secure AI tool that fits your environment (Microsoft 365 / Google Workspace / ChatGPT Teams/Enterprise).
- License everyone in Finance so adoption doesn't fragment.
- Publish house rules: what can/can't be shared, how outputs are reviewed, where prompts/templates live.

Goal: One approved tool, one set of rules, one shared starting point.

97. Weeks 1-2 - 1-hour "Eye-Opener" Kickoff (Fast Belief Shift)

Many finance professionals think AI is either (a) gimmicky, or (b) too risky. A short, hands-on kickoff is the fastest way to replace skepticism with practical confidence.

Do this

- Demo real finance use cases across FP&A, Accounting, Treasury (not generic "write an email" examples).
- Teach a simple prompting framework that works in finance (structured inputs, outputs, and checks).
- Explain risks + limitations plainly (hallucinations, confidentiality, overreliance) and how to mitigate (review, sanitization, restricted use).
- End with: "Try these 3 prompts today" + a shared prompt sheet so action is immediate.

Goal: Get people to try AI the same day-on real finance work.

98. Week 3 - Hands-on Workshop (Learning by Doing)

One-time demos don't change behavior. People adopt when they practice on their own workflows and leave with reusable assets (prompts, templates, and repeatable steps).

Do this

- Run a 2-hour, camera-on session with exercises using your actual finance workflows.
- Teach a structured workflow for real analysis (not "chat"): verify -> analyze -> calculate -> visualize -> write commentary.
- Introduce lightweight automation (custom GPTs/agents) as a practical next step-without turning it into an IT project.

Goal: Convert interest into repeatable execution.

99. Week 3 - Launch a Collaborative "AI Wins" Channel

After every workshop, individuals will then turn to "private learning." It's best to make sure that everyone in the team is also sharing and learning. Having a shared channel creates visibility, normalizes experimentation, and spreads reusable prompts fast.

Do this

- Create a dedicated Slack/Teams channel (e.g., #finance-ai-wins).
- Keep sharing lightweight: Problem -> Prompt -> Output -> Impact (plus link/template if safe).
- Add simple guardrails: sanitize data, don't post confidential outputs, and clarify review expectations.
- Identify a couple of "champions" who keep momentum by answering questions and highlighting wins.

Goal: Turn AI learning into a team sport.

100. Week 4 and Ongoing - Reinforce & Scale (Events + Agents +

Metrics)

AI adoption isn't a launch, it's a habit. Without a cadence, usage drops after the workshop. With a cadence, improvements stack and people build real internal tools (agents) that stick.

Do this

- Every 2 weeks: Lunch & Learn (20-30 min demo + 20-30 min Q&A; rotate presenters). This keeps effort low and learning high.
- After ~1 month: run a simple hackathon to build the first internal agents people will actually use (commentary bot, policy Q&A, deck drafts, cleanup assistants).
- Track outcomes that matter to Finance: cycle time, throughput, quality (e.g., time-to-first-insight, forecast turnaround, fewer manual steps), not just "hours saved."

Goal: Make adoption durable and measurable.

Conclusion

You've reached the end of the 100 Tips for AI in Finance Handbook.

If there's one thing to remember, it's this: AI is no longer a future topic for finance - it's an operating skill.

This handbook was designed to move you beyond curiosity and experimentation. The real value comes when these tips turn into habits: how you analyze data, how you forecast, how you communicate, how you design processes, and how you lead your finance function.

These 100 tips are not a checklist to complete once. They are a toolbox you'll come back to again and again. Start small, apply a few tips, stabilize them, and then scale. The compounding effect is where the real impact happens.

Once you master prompting, structure your workflows, and choose the right use cases, you'll quickly realize that what's written is only the baseline. From there, you'll be able to do 10x more - faster, with better quality, and with more confidence.

Final takeaway

AI is an operating skill for finance. Start small, verify every material output, stabilise useful workflows and scale only when governance, ownership and measurable value are in place.

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